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Image simulated. Samsung account login may be required for certain AI features. Actual UX/UI may differ. Samsung promotes responsible use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) features. T&C apply. *Based on internal research as of July 22, 2026, comparing commercially available book-style foldable smartphones globally. Exact weight may vary by model, configuration, and manufacturing process. Weight measured excluding protective cases or accessories. [#]EMI amount ₹ 4375 is computed on 40 months No Cost EMI including 10 months down payment at the price of ₹ 179999 for 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold8 12|256GB, inclusive of taxes. EMI rounded off to nearest rupee for ease of reference. 40|10 is available with Bajaj Finance only. Samsung disclaims any liabilities with the same. Aforesaid calculations are for illustrative purposes, final price at the sole discretion of retailer. Offer may be revised or withdrawn without any prior notice. 30 months No cost EMI is available with select NBFC partners i.e. TVS Credit, IDFC First Bank & PFL. With rest of the NBFC partners, 24|0 can be availed. Eligibility for EMI at the sole discretion of the financiers including those listed on Samsung Finance+ (Financier T&C applies). Samsung disclaims any liabilities with the same.



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Model Name	Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra	Galaxy Z Fold8
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Net Effective Price* (1 unit)	₹ 91999	₹ 71999

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Seven years on, China President Xi to visit India

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

China announced on Thursday that President Xi Jinping will attend the BRICS Summit in New Delhi this weekend, on what will be his first visit to India in almost seven years.

Mr. Xi last visited in October 2019 for an informal summit with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Mammallapuram in Tamil Nadu. The two leaders are expected to meet for bilateral talks on the sidelines of the coming summit in New Delhi.

Mr. Xi will be accompanied by a large delegation, including Politburo member and Foreign Minister Wang Yi, and Commerce Minister Wang Wentao, who is likely to have talks on the sidelines with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, his counterpart.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 14**

SC asks Centre to review NEET-SS cut-off decision

Super-specialty medical seats remaining vacant makes a 'rather compelling' case for reduction of qualifying percentile, top court says; willing to hold a 'stray round' for unfilled seats, says Centre

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court asked the Union government on Thursday to reconsider its decision not to reduce the cut-off percentile for National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test-Super-specialty (NEET-SS) seats in the current year, while expressing concern about a large number of seats going unfilled annually.

The order from a Bench of Justices P.S. Narasimha and Alok Aradhe came after Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, for the Centre, said the government was willing to conduct a "stray round" for the vacant NEET-SS seats, but had decided not to lower the qualifying percentile. She said the vacant

Staking claim

The petition has challenged the 'premature diversion' of 152 vacant Super-specialty seats earmarked for in-service government doctors in Tamil Nadu to the all-India quota

What the petition says

- At least **40 seats** remain vacant from those diverted, and they should be returned to Tamil Nadu
- Many eligible candidates, mostly in-service government doctors serving in rural parts of the State, are **awaiting a reduction** in the qualifying percentile
- NEET-SS seats are **'precious'** and cannot remain vacant



seats would revert to States such as Tamil Nadu.

The court was hearing a petition filed by the Tamil Nadu Medical Officers Association, represented by senior advocate P. Wilson, who said Tamil Nadu had 40 vacant seats left, and they should be returned to the State. The petitioner-

association had challenged the "premature diversion" of 152 vacant super-specialty seats earmarked for in-service government doctors in Tamil Nadu to the all-India quota. It had also sought protection of the State's in-service reservation policy, pending a final decision on reduction of

the NEET-SS qualifying percentile.

Mr. Wilson stressed that many eligible candidates, mostly in-service government doctors serving in rural parts of the State, were awaiting a reduction in the qualifying percentile. He said the NEET-SS seats were "precious", and cannot remain vacant. Senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi, for Tamil Nadu, said the State wanted the vacant seats to completely revert to it. He further urged the top court to lower the cut-off percentile.

The court said the fact that many seats remain unfilled makes the case for reduction of the qualifying percentile "rather compelling".

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» **PAGE 14**

Take action against threats to minor NEET protester: SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday asked Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta to ensure "immediate action" on a complaint filed by a 14-year-old student, who alleged open threats and harassment from miscreants for her role in the protests against NEET-UG question paper leaks.

"These are anti-social elements. They commit violence against a child, and they roam free. Now, they are again trying to browbeat and intimidate the child and her family, so that they do not proceed with any legal action. This is a very serious issue. Her cause is absolutely justified," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, observed.

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India-Canada trade deal by the end of the year, says envoy

Suhasini Haidar
T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The India-Canada trade deal will be ready by the end of the year, Canadian High Commissioner Christopher Cooter has told *The Hindu*, adding that the two countries are planning for their increased engagement this year to culminate in a visit by Prime Minister Narendra Modi to the North American country in December.

Speaking at *The Hindu MIND* in New Delhi on Wednesday, Mr. Cooter said that the two countries had ample opportunities for bilateral investment which could scale up to \$1 trillion. He did, however, point out that India could ease some tax and regulatory hurdles to spur further investment, something on which Canada has been engaging with the Union



Christopher Cooter

Finance Ministry.

"Previously, we discussed for 12 years, and we got no trade agreement," Mr. Cooter said. "This time, we started in March 2026. We have probably done more in these six months than we did in those 12 years... I am pretty confident the trade deal will be agreed to by the end of the year," he said.

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EDITORIAL
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Riyas Komu's work will feature at the event. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Sakshi Gallery's 'Of Being and Becoming' opens to public today

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Sakshi Gallery is marking its 40th anniversary with 'Of Being and Becoming', an exhibition featuring over 46 artists across three generations at Travancore Palace in New Delhi.

Curated by museologist and writer Manan Shah, the exhibition will open on Friday and continue till September 20.

"Of Being and Becoming introduces audiences to the changing visual syntax of the last four decades, showcasing together both

early and recent works by artists who have significantly shaped the landscape of visual arts in India," Mr. Shah said.

Artist Riyas Komu, whose work will feature at the event, said he has been associated with the gallery since his student days. "Sakshi was the first gallery that responded to my work," Mr. Komu told *The Hindu*. He is showcasing 'Walking Towards the National Museum II', made between 2008 and 2026, using recycled wood, concrete, mild steel, stainless steel, adhesive and acrylic.

MCD suspends 3 more after Sept. 6 collapse; Delhi to get own disaster response force

Eight civic officials punished so far in crackdown following Satya Niketan tragedy; will set up our own force to reduce dependence on external assistance, says CM; 41 structures razed on Thursday

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Thursday suspended an Assistant Engineer and two Junior Engineers of the South West Zone for "dereliction of duty" and "negligence in acting against unauthorised constructions" in the area, said an official.

With this, the count of officials suspended by the civic body since the September 6 building collapse in Satya Niketan in which seven persons, including five students, lost their lives, stands at eight.

The municipality had suspended five officials on September 7, including Deputy Commissioner Rakesh Kumar of the South Zone, under which the site of the collapse falls.

'Remain vigilant'

In a release, the MCD stated that negligence by officials towards unauthorised construction would not be tolerated and directed field officers to remain vigilant and take timely action against violations.

The suspensions of Assistant Engineer Ravinder Kumar and Junior Engineers Suman Saurabh and Mohit Yadav come amid an intensified citywide crackdown on unauthorised and dangerous buildings by the municipality.



MCD officials inspecting PG facilities in Satya Niketan on Wednesday; the civic body sealed 61 properties across the city on Thursday; (right) a view of the collapse site. PTI/ANI



The MCD carried out 41 demolitions and issued orders to raze three more illegal structures on Thursday. Additionally, it sealed 61 properties and issued 32 show-cause notices.

The civic body has so far identified 1,355 buildings in the city with PG facilities accommodating nearly 27,000 occupants. However, it is yet to declare how many of these are illegal.

The Delhi government will set up its own State Disaster Response Force (SDRF) and provide specialised training to fire department personnel and civil defence volunteers so that rescue teams have the necessary skills to respond to emergency situations, the Chief Minister's (CM) Office said on Thursday.

It added that the move is also aimed at improving

coordination between various agencies while responding to disasters.

The statement quoted CM Rekha Gupta as saying that setting up an SDRF in the Capital had been a long-standing demand and that most States already have their own SDRFs.

"For a densely populated city such as Delhi, having its own SDRF is the need of the hour. It could not take shape under the previous governments. But our government will now move forward in this direction to reduce dependence on external assistance during disasters and strengthen the city's capacity for an immediate local response," she said.

Earlier in the day, Ms. Gupta chaired a meeting on setting up the force, which was attended by se-

nior officials of the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), including Director General Piyush Anand.

The NDRF offered to assist in setting up a battalion of up to 1,100 personnel. "NDRF officials said they would also assist with specialised equipment, keeping in mind Delhi's geographical conditions," read the statement.

L-G clears panel

Meanwhile, Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday approved the constitution of an 18-member panel, chaired by Education Minister Ashish Sood, to ensure safety, security and adequate availability of student housing.

CASE TO REMAIN WITH HC
» PAGE 4



Various student outfits and Oppn. parties have raised the issue of inadequate hostels at DU following the building collapse. FILE PHOTO



DU to add 5.5K seats to existing hostel capacity of 7,210 over five years

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi University is set to increase its hostel capacity by over 5,500 seats to 12,754 over the next five years, officials said on Thursday.

At present, there are 7,210 hostel seats for around 2.5 lakh university students. The announcement comes amid growing worries among outstation students regarding safe and affordable student housing following the Satya Niketan building collapse, which housed a PG facility. Several student groups, including the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), have held candlelight marches and protests since the September 6 tragedy over the absence of hostel accommodation.

According to official data, the university has 3,422 hostel seats while the capacity across affiliated colleges is 3,788.

Earlier this week, DU Vice-Chancellor Yogesh Singh asked college principals to review residential facilities for students and expedite work on under-construction hostels.

New hostels

The university has been working to expand hostel facilities over the past few years and is planning to submit proposals for several new projects to the government, it stated in a release on Thursday.

The statement added that an Institute of Emi-



nence hostel with a capacity of 1,450 seats is nearing completion at the university's Dhaka Complex.

Construction on a 1,000-seat women's hostel, 'Nirbhaya Residential Accommodation', is also under way. A studio apartment complex with a capacity of 1,050 seats is among the other projects under construction, the university also said.

DUSU polls

Meanwhile, candidates for the September 18 DU Students' Union (DUSU) polls filed nomination papers on Thursday.

As per the tentative list, there are 25 candidates for the president's post, 20 for vice-president, 24 for secretary and 19 for joint secretary. Candidates have until 12 noon on Friday to withdraw their names, after which the final list will be published. The ABVP has identified seven probable candidates while the National Students' Union of India plans to announce four candidates on Friday.

15,000 police personnel deployed for BRICS meet

Lavpreet Kaur
Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

Around 15,000 Delhi Police personnel and 200 companies of paramilitary forces have been deployed as part of a multi-layered security arrangement for the 18th BRICS summit that will be held in the national capital this weekend.

At least 16 heads of state or government and their delegations are expected to be present in the city over the next three days.

Security has been stepped up at designated venues, hotels, historical sites, and locations where scheduled or unscheduled meetings could take place. Surveillance has been intensified on VVIP routes.

Special Commissioner of Police (Protective Security Division) Manish Agrawal said there was multi-agency coordination with Central agencies, the National Security Guard, and other forces for law and order and security arrangements. "Restrictions on traffic have been made keeping in mind that there is no inconvenience to the public. There are restrictions on traffic, but no route has been completely closed," he said.

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LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE SUPREME COURT OF INDIA
EXTRA-ORDINARY APPELLATE
JURISDICTION
Petition for Special Leave to Appeal (Civil) No.
7135 OF 2026
RAJENDER SINGH AND ANOTHER
... Petitioner(s)

VERSUS
SURENDER KUMAR PAWAR
AND OTHERS
... Respondent(s)

1 BALDEV RAJ, S/O KANWAR BHAN R/O
1-28B-FF, LAJPAT NAGAR-II, NEW DELHI,
DISTRICT - OTHER

PID: 2296322626 FOR RPI[2]
SERVO NO.7135/2026 (SEC IV-B)

WHEREAS THE PETITIONER FOR SPECIAL LEAVE
PETITION (CIVIL) to Appeal with application for
EXEMPTION FROM FILING C/O OF THE
IMPUGNED JUDGMENT, EXEMPTION FROM
FILING O.T., filed in the Registry by Mr. NIKHIL
BENIWAL, Advocate on behalf of the Petitioner
above named was listed for hearing before this
Court on 13th February, 2026, when the Court was
pleased to pass the following order:-

"1. Delay condoned.
2. Issue notices, returnable in six weeks."

AND WHEREAS, the service of show cause notice
could not be effected on unreturned Respondent
No.2 and the matter above mentioned was listed
before Ld. Registrar's Court on 2nd September,
2026, when the following order was passed:-

"Respondent No.1 is duly represented. Last
opportunity is granted to respondent No.1 to file
counter affidavit within a week. If counter
affidavit is filed as above, let the same be taken
on record, else further opportunity to file the
same would stand declined, as service was
complete in April, 2026.

Service was complete on respondent No.3 to
15 but none has entered appearance.

Ld. Counsel for the petitioner has not filed
affidavit alongwith proof of publication in
respect of respondent No.2. However, Ld.
Counsel for the petitioner, Mr. Nikhil Beniwali
has on 25-08-2026 filed an application for
modification of order dated 28-07-2026 seeking
modification of mode of substituted service on
respondent No.2 stating therein that service
may be effected through publication in
newspapers namely "The Hindu" (English) and
"Punjab Kesari" (Hindi) in place of "Indian
Express" (English) and "Jansatta" (Hindi).
The application is hereby allowed. Ld. Counsel
for the petitioner to file affidavit alongwith proof
of publication within two weeks as last
opportunity. If needful is done as above, list on
08.10.2026, else Registry to process the matter
for listing before the Hon'ble Judge in
Chambers for default.

Copy of this Record of Proceeding be furnished
to the concerned Ld. Advocate-on-record for
information and compliance."

NOW, THEREFORE, TAKE NOTICE that the
above petition alongwith application for
EXEMPTION FROM FILING C/O OF THE
IMPUGNED JUDGMENT, EXEMPTION FROM
FILING O.T. will be posted for hearing before this
Court in due course when you may appear before
this Court either in person or through advocate on
record of this Court duly appointed by you in that
behalf within thirty days from the date of service
of notice. You may thereafter show cause to the Court
on the day that may subsequently be specified as to
why Special Leave Petition and the resultant appeal
be not allowed.

You may file your affidavit in opposition to the
petition as provided under Rule 14(f) of Order XXI,
S.O. 2015 within 30 days from the date of receipt
of notice or not later than 2 weeks before the date
appointed for hearing, whichever be earlier, but
shall do so only by setting out the grounds in
opposition to the questions of law or grounds set out
in the SLPs and may produce such pleadings and
documents filed before the Court/Tribunal against
whose order the SPECIAL LEAVE PETITION
(CIVIL) is filed and shall also set out the grounds for
not granting interim order or for vacating interim
order already granted.

TAKE FURTHER NOTICE that if you fail to enter
appearance as aforesaid, no further notice shall be
given to you even after the grant of special leave for
hearing of the resultant appeal & the matter above
mentioned shall be disposed of in your absence.

Dated: 03rd September, 2026
ASSISTANT REGISTRAR

PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

I, KM Kamla Devi, w/o Surjeet
Singh, r/o House No. TA-95, Tughlak-
abad Extn, New Delhi-110019, have
changed my name to Kamlesh Kaur
dt 09/09/2026

PERSONAL

LOST & FOUND

I, ANSHU Mala Tyagi, Director of
Darox Electronics Pvt. Ltd., de-
clare that the original DSIIDC El-
ligibility Letter for Plot M-171,
Sector-5, Bawana Industrial Area,
has been lost/misplaced and re-
mains untraced.

PUBLIC NOTICE

WE, Meenu Gupta W/o Sh. Panikaj Gupta,
Panikaj Gupta S/o Late Sh. Armit Lal Gupta
& Sarthak Gupta S/o Sh. Panikaj Gupta, all
R/O D-104, Amar Colony, Lajpat Nagar-IV,
New Delhi-110024, intend to purchase Half
2nd Floor, D-105, Amar Colony, Lajpat
Nagar-IV, New Delhi-110024 from Sh.
Deepak Bhutani. Any person having any
claim, right, title, interest or objection in
respect of the said property/transaction
may intimate the undersigned within 7
days of publication of this notice, failing
which no claim/objection shall be
entertained thereafter.

Meenu Gupta | Panikaj Gupta | Sarthak Gupta
D-104, Amar Colony, Lajpat Nagar-IV,
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Physical Inspection: Mr. Ankit Gupta-
9350555395 Last Date For Inspection
& EMD Deposit -17.09.2026 & Date Of
E-auction-18.09.2026 (3PM),
Auctioneer: Meenakshi Gupta-
9625137014 (Insurance Claim Material
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1.Submission of Technical Bid:16-09-2026 at 10:00 AM
05.00 PM

2.Opening of Technical Bid:16-09-2026 at 10:00 AM

3.Opening of Financial Bid:17-09-2026 at 10:00AM

1. Executive Engineer Shimla Urban Division, HP, PWD., Shimla-3

Govt. of HP invites Percentage Fee basis tender from Empaneled

Consultants (by HPPWD), minimum 3 no. for comprehensive

architectural planning, designing and DPR preparation, as per the

schedule as under:

Estimated Project Cost of this work is approx.Rs.200 Crores.(Tentative).

The Client Department will supply the :-

1. The detailed requirement of the project along with the

area requirement (can vary upto 10%)

2. The plot of the area. 17127.00 sqm

3. The revenue papers of the site.

4. Requirement of Accommodation:- Copy Attached

Name of the work Re-Construction of State Guest House Peter

Hoff building at Chaura Maidan Shimla.

Client/ Executive Engineer Shimla Urban Division,

Owner HP, PWD., Shimla.

Brief Scope After approval of Conceptual Plans by Executive

of Work Engineer Shimla Urban Division, HP, PWD., Shimla.

(a) Preparation of the Detailed lay out plan, structural

designs and drawings including floor plans with

specifications of the materials and items including

false ceilings, architectural design of the New

proposed building in conformity with the legal

requirements. Area and CLU certificate is attached as

"Annexure-A". Approximate total plot area is 17127.00

Square meter and built up area will be 18640.50 Sq.

meter.

(b) Architectural Structural shall be detailed and Structural

design shall confirm to latest "Indian Standards on

Earthquake Engineering" and other relevant code as

applicable.

(c) The project falls in the earthquake Zone-4.

(d) Architectural Structural of Sanitary & Plumbing

(External & Internal)

(e) Architectural Structural of Electrification (External &

Internal connections of power) with Power Back up

systems including lay out and specifications of solar

panels.

(f) Interior design, Furniture lay out, Air conditioning

system, Fire protection & detection systems, Access

Control & PA System, lift, site development, parking,

gates and boundary wall and landscaping workings.

(g) The Total Station Survey & Soil Bearing Capacity

(SBC) report.

(h) Architectural Structural of approach road/internal road

from existing main road.

(i) Green building specifications and rainwater harvesting

also where green building certification is required.

(j) Assist in Obtaining all clearance from govt. agencies

as required for such a project.

(k) To carry out Inspections and site visits during the

construction of Executive Engineer Shimla Urban

Division HP, PWD., Shimla. Digital walk through of

the project.

Estimated To be quoted on Percentage fee basis inclusive of all

Consultancy taxes and charges but exclusive of GST. Maximum

Fees amount quoted by the consultant shall not exceed

1.5% of the effective project cost for composite

consultancy services.

For the individual consultancy services, the quoted

amount shall not exceed:-

Architectural consultancy—0.75% of the effective

project cost

Structural consultancy — 0.50% of the effective

project cost

Quantity survey —0.25% of the effective project cost

Effective cost of the project is the total Expenditure on

the Project in which services of the consultant are

rendered. It excludes GST and other direct expenditure

occurred by the Client department on the project.

RFP document my please be downloaded form departmental

website <https://hppwd.hp.gov.in>.

-HIM SUCHNA AVAM JAN SAMPARK HP / 3266-26-27

THE HINDU

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KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

(CIN: U40109KA1999SGC025521)

No. CEE/T&P/SEE-2/2026-27/6352-76 Dated : 10.09.2026

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION

(Through KPP Portal Only)

KPTCL invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Partial Turnkey basis.**

Sl. No.	Enquiry Nos. and Name of the works
1	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4175 Establishing 2x20MVA, 110/11kV sub-station at Thadusuru in Tiptur Taluk, Tumakuru District and Construction of 110kV LILO line from 110kV KB cross-Tiptaturu-Keragodi-Hunseghatta SC line for a distance of 0.140km using Lynx conductor.
2	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4172 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Sasvihalli Village in Harapanahalli Taluk, Vijayanagara District along with construction of associated 66kV DC line for a distance of 7.085kms and construction of 02 no's. of 66kV Terminal Bays at existing 66/11kV Bennehalli sub-station.
3	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4173 Establishing 2x20MVA, 110/11kV sub-station at Masuti in Kolhar Taluk, Vijayapur District along with construction of associated 110kV LILO line for a distance of 0.906km .
4	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4176 Establishing 2x20MVA, 66/11kV sub-station at Tuppadahalli (Kenchapura) Village in Chennagiri Taluk, Davanagere District by constructing 66kV DC line on DC/MC towers from 220/66kV Benkikere sub-station by utilizing the existing corridor of 66kV Benkikere-Ramagiri SC line using Panther conductor & Construction of 66kV SC link line from proposed 66/11kV Tuppadahalli station to link existing 66kV Benkikere-Ramagiri SC line using Panther conductor for a distance of 19.891kms along with construction of 02 no's of 66kV Terminal Bays at 220/66kV Benkikere sub-station.
5	KPTCL/2026-27/SS/WORK_INDENT4174 Establishing 2x20MVA, 110/11kV sub-station at Kandakur in Gurmikhal Taluk, Yadgir District along with construction of associated 110kV LILO line for a distance of 6.912km .

The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the E-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website

Karnataka limits rendition of *Vande Mataram* to 2 stanzas

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka government has issued an order stating that only the first two stanzas of the national song *Vande Mataram* are to be sung at State functions. The stand is in line with that of the Congress at the national level.

However, the entire six stanzas will be played or sung in functions involving the President, Vice-President, Prime Minister, or Governor, the order states. The order, issued by the Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms (DIPR), follows a Cabinet decision.

The order acknowledges that *Vande Mataram* played an important role in instilling nationalism,



The order issued by Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms follows a decision by the State Cabinet. FILE PHOTO

unity, and patriotism among the people of the country during the Indian national movement for freedom.

It refers to the guidelines issued by the Union Ministry of Home Affairs prescribing the singing of the official version of the song, as well as the proce-

dure to be followed while singing or playing it at various government and public programmes.

However, the order says that the State government has considered the need to maintain ‘uniformity, dignity and appropriate protocol’ with regard to the singing of *Vande Mataram*.

Bengal CM defends ‘godman’ amid row over vegetarian *pujo*

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Thursday defended Bageshwar Dham chief priest Dharendra Krishna Shastri whose recent remarks to “keep non-vegetarian food away” from Durga Puja pandals sparked a row in the State.

“... Even if you don’t keep the idols of the Goddess, do not sell non-vegetarian food near the idols,” Mr. Shastri had said on September 6 during a visit to Kolkata.

Speaking in the Assembly, Mr. Adhikari said, “...Those who want to accept will accept and those who do not want will not. He (Mr. Shastri) did not impose it on anyone. I saw a number of people burning his photographs outside police station. I am directing the Commissioner of Police that these people need to be arrested.”

Mr. Adhikari’s remarks came after Congress supporters staged a protest outside the Bhawanipore police station on September 8 over Mr. Shastri’s remarks.

☀️ Timings DELHI			
FRIDAY, SEP. 11			
RISE	06:04	SET	18:31
RISE	06:02	SET	18:33
SATURDAY, SEP. 12			
RISE	06:05	SET	18:30
RISE	07:03	SET	19:04
SUNDAY, SEP. 13			
RISE	06:05	SET	18:29
RISE	08:02	SET	19:35

Delhi Weather			max	min
Delhi City	36	27		
Safdarjang	36	27		
Palam	34	24		

Delhi Palam Today
35°C The weather will be dry. Day will be warm with moderate winds. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C Rise in temperature. The weather will be very warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable. Mostly dry weather to occur.

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Gauhati HC seeks clarity on rehabilitation of those evicted

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Gauhati High Court has sought clarity from the Assam government on providing rehabilitation and compensation to people displaced during an eviction drive in September 2024.

The Kamrup Metropolitan district authorities conducted the eviction drive at Kachutoli in the Sonapur

area to clear 100 bighas of notified tribal land. The evicted were mostly migrant Bengali Muslims.

In an order on September 7, Justice Devashis Barua issued notices to various government departments to record their stands on the plea for rehabilitation and compensation by 76 petitioners through affidavits by October 6.

The petitioners repre-

sent some of the 650 families, comprising about 2,000 people, who were evicted from September 23 to 25, 2024, their advocate Zunaid Khalid said.

The court observed that the petitioners have been residing on private patta land (property whose ownership is officially recorded) after they were “evicted from their occupation” without receiving any rehabilitation or compensation.

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Two A.P. students try to harm classmate to get ‘holiday’, expelled

Two Class 8 students of a Gurukul Patashala in Annamayya district of Andhra Pradesh were issued transfer certificates from the school following allegations that they attempted to harm a classmate while he was asleep in the hostel. According to officials, the student approached the Mandal Education Department and alleged that the two boys had pressed his neck. He reportedly managed to escape and brought the matter to the notice of the authorities.

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Branch Relocation Notice
On Behalf of ICICI Bank Ltd., Jalia-II Branch

Dear Customers,

We wish to inform you that with effect from October 12, 2026, we are relocating to a more convenient location. The address is as mentioned below:

New address: ICICI Bank Ltd., Sharma Kuteer, Opposite Post Office, Main Road, Jalia II, Dist-Beawar, Rajasthan-305625

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Sincerely,
Branch Manager, Jalia-II Branch

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M.P. hooch toll hits 16; women demand liquor ban

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The death toll in Madhya Pradesh's Sagar hooch tragedy climbed to 16 on Thursday following the death of another person, while more than 40 others, including three who are critical, remain hospitalised, according to officials.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Sagar Collector Pratibha Pal said, "The official death toll is at 16 currently based on cause of death revealed in the post-mortem reports. Viscera samples of some people, whose post-mortem reports did not link their deaths to counterfeit liquor or did not show an exact cause of death, have been sent for



Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav has ordered a judicial inquiry into the tragedy. FILE PHOTO

forensic analysis." Ms. Pal stated that authorities will update the official count if forensics confirm the results. She said three of them are in critical conditions and more than 60 have been discharged.

Meanwhile, five illegal properties of three accused, Chandrabhan Rajpoot alias Chandu Raja, Manish Lodhi and Ashish Sahu, were demolished by the authorities on Thursday.

The action comes a day after Chief Minister Mohan Yadav visited Sagar and said that the government has given a "free hand" to the local police and administration to take action against those involved in the illicit liquor trade.

Ms. Pal said that the properties were illegal and had been built on encroached lands.

The Collector said that the test reports of the counterfeit liquor seized from the accused are still awaited.

"But it is suspected that they had mixed high percentage of methanol in the liquor," she said.

Ms. Pal also said that the health department teams have so far screened peo

ple from 125 villages in Banda and Shahgarh sub-divisions to check for any symptoms related to the spurious liquor consumption.

Protest in villages

Meanwhile, women in various villages in the region also held demonstrations while demanding a complete ban on alcohol in the region.

"You could get local-made and branded liquor at kirana shops... The police and administration are well aware of this but barely take an action," said Seema Rajak, mother of Durgesh Rajak, who is admitted at a government-run hospital after having lost his vision.

Post-mortem reveals Manipuri singer died of internal bleeding after assault

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Manipuri musician Chongtham Vikram Singh died of massive internal bleeding caused by severe physical trauma to his chest and abdomen, according to a post-mortem report released on Thursday. The fatal injuries occurred after a group of men allegedly attacked 54-year-old Singh because he had confronted them over noise outside his house in Kilokari village on Sunday.

The alleged attackers used their feet to beat Singh on the chest and abdomen after he fell to the ground, a senior police of

ficer said, adding that the post-mortem findings established the nature of the injuries caused during the assault.

Dr. Sudhir Gupta, Chief of Forensic Medicine at AI-IMS, said Singh died as a result of severe physical assault on his abdomen and chest, which resulted in massive bleeding.

"The person died as a result of severe physical assault on the abdomen and chest, which resulted in massive bleeding and death," Gupta said.

According to police, Singh, who was taken to Holy Family Hospital, initially responded positively to treatment but subse

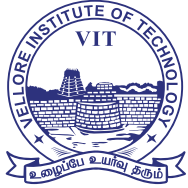
quently suffered a haemorrhage and died.

Police arrested seven men and apprehended a juvenile, identifying the accused as Bharat Kumar (19), Pramod (26), Ramzan Khan (22), Deepanshu (21), Mohan Vishwakarma (32), Vijay (36) and Mannu (26).

Police are examining all aspects of the case, including whether there was any racial angle.

far, the investigation has not revealed any instance of a racial slur being used against Singh during the altercation, a police source said.

An FIR has been registered on the complaint of Singh's son.



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Chief Guest



Dr Suchitra Ella
Co-Founder & Managing Director,
Bharat Biotech,
CII-President Designate

Presided by



Dr G Viswanathan
Founder & Chancellor,
Vellore Institute of Technology
(VIT)

Event Schedule

Inauguration

10:00 AM Onwards



Welcome Address

10:10 AM to 10:15 AM

Suresh Nambath, Editor, The Hindu



Special Address

10:15 AM to 10:20 AM

Dr G V Selvam, Vice-President, VIT



Presidential Address

10:20 AM to 10:30 AM

Dr G Viswanathan, Founder & Chancellor,
Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT)



Inaugural Address

10:30 AM to 10:50 AM

Dr Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder & Managing Director, Bharat Biotech,
CII-President Designate



Student Interaction Session
with the Chief Guest

11:10 AM to 11:45 AM

Dr Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder & Managing Director, Bharat Biotech,
CII-President Designate



Role of Technology in Biotechnology

11:50 AM to 12:35 PM

Dr Ganapathy, Honorary Distinguished Professor, IIM Jammu,
Distinguished Professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R. Medical University,
Emeritus Professor, National Academy of Medical Sciences
Mayur Abhaya, Managing Director, LifeCell International
Dr Shridevi S, Deputy Director, Centre for Neuroinformatics, VIT Chennai
in conversation with Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu



VIT Chennai Ecosystem for
Translational Research

12:40 PM to 12:45 PM

Dr T Thyagarajan, Pro-Vice Chancellor, VIT Chennai



Gene Editing and Precision Medicine

2:00 PM to 2:45 PM

Dr Vinod Scaria, Chief Data Officer, Karkinos Healthcare
Dr Kalpana Gowrishankar, Clinical Geneticist and Counselor,
Apollo Hospitals
Dr G Jayaraman, Dean, School of Bio Sciences and Technology,
VIT Chennai
in conversation with Geetha Srimathi S, Senior Reporter, The Hindu



India as the Global Biopharma Hub

2:50 PM to 3:35 PM

Dr Maneesh Paul, CEO, Microvioma, Lead Co-Inventor & Program
Director of the Anti-Infective Enmetazobactam, Orchid Pharma
Dr Vasan Sambandamurthy, Senior Vice-President,
Bugworks Research India Pvt Ltd
Dr M M Balamurali, Professor, Centre for Healthcare Advancement,
Innovation & Research, VIT Chennai
in conversation with Athira Elssa Johnson, Senior Reporter, The Hindu



Funding Landscape for Biotech Research in India

3:40 PM to 4:15 PM

Ajay Mahipal, Co-Founder and General Partner, HealthKois
in conversation with Serena Josephine M, Special
Correspondent, The Hindu



Biotech Research and Innovation Ecosystem in India

4:20 PM to 4:55 PM

Prof K VijayRaghavan, National Centre for Biological Sciences,
Tata Institute of Fundamental Research
in conversation with Jacob Koshy, Science Editor, The Hindu



Vote of Thanks

5:00 PM to 5:05 PM

Dr G Jayaraman, Dean, School of Bio Sciences
and Technology, VIT Chennai



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Corrigendum & Addendum
With reference to Advertisement No. 1/34/ER/ACAD/2026-2027 dated 31.07.2026; it is to be noted that:
I. The age limit may be relaxable for exceptionally qualified candidates at the discretion of the selection committee, within the upper limit as prescribed by NMC. There will be no age relaxation for SC/ST/OBC candidates applying for unreserved seat.
II. Government servants and candidates belonging to scheduled castes/scheduled tribes/ other backward class will get age relaxation as per Uttar Pradesh Govt. rules/orders. The rest points will remain unchanged.
It is also notified that last date for accepting of applications and cut-off date for determining the qualification & experience and upper age limit is extended till **30th September, 2026.**
Advt. No. 1/47/ER/ACAD/ 2026-27**DIRECTOR**



Karnataka Renewable Energy Development Limited
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
#6/13/1, 10th Block, 2nd Stage, Nagarabhavi, Bengaluru - 560072. Ph-080-22282220,
E-mail:kredlmd@gmail.com, www.kredl.karnataka.gov.in
No. KREDL/07/SG/F-2052/Call/2/2026-27 Date: 10.09.2026

SHORT-TERM E-TENDER NOTIFICATION
Karnataka Renewable Energy Development Limited (KREDL), Government of Karnataka undertaking hereby invites short-term tender for **Selection of Developer(s) for Setting up of 250 MW/500 MWh BESS at Kushtagi Taluk, Koppala District and 200 MW/400 MWh BESS at Huliurdurga, Kunigal Taluk, Tumakuru District** to be interconnected to respective KPTCL Receiving Stations, in Karnataka under Tariff Based Competitive Bidding with bidding parameter as **Availability Based Fixed Charge in INR per MW per Month (exclusive of GST).**
Tender documents will be available in the ISN-ETS Portal(<https://www.bharat-electronictender.com>) **on or after 11.09.2026.** The last date for submission of bids is **28.09.2026.** Any further amendments, if any, shall be notified only through the ISN-ETS Portal(<https://www.bharat-electronictender.com>).
Sd/- General Manager-Technical, KREDL

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WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM NOTICE-I Date: 08.09.2026
Tender Notice No. JBP-N-SIG-TENDER-2026-36 Dated-03.09.2026
NAME OF WORK:- Enhancing the reliability of existing Signalling gears by replacement of outlived ELD, Batteries & Track feed charger of KTE-MKP & KTE - SGRL section of Jabalpur Division on West Central Railway The above-mentioned tender which was to be closing date on 05.10.2026 has following amendment- **Item description of Schedule A item no. 1, 2, 3 and 9 is modified. Note-** For details visit website <https://www.ireps.gov.in> All other terms & conditions in the Tender remain unchanged. The inconvenience caused is regretted. **Sd/- Div. Railway Manager (S&T) West Central Railway, Jabalpur**



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ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION DESIGN CIRCLE
10th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extn., Lucknow

INVITES-OPEN TENDER (GeM)
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“DESIGN, DETAILED ENGINEERING, MANUFACTURE & SUPPLY OF 220 KV & 132KV CORRUGATED ALUMINIUM SHEATHED XLPE CABLES, JOINT & TERMINATIONS AND ACCESSORIES FOR O&M WORK UNDER UPPTCL”
Tender Specification no- TD-560/26
Bid Portal (download & submission): www.gem.gov.in
Bidding: Online, EMD: Rs. 5.69 Lakh
Bid No. GEM/2026/B/8010202 dated 10.09.2026
KEY DATES:
Online Bid Submission Start: 10.09.2026, 14:00 Hrs.
Online Bid Submission Closing: 29.09.2026, 16:00 Hrs.
Technical Bid Opening: 30.09.2026, 16:00 Hrs. onwards
Bidders are advised to visit GeM-portal regularly for amendments/corrigendum etc.
E-Mail: seetdc@upptcl.org | Tele: (0522) 2286759, 2218645



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E-mail: sspkathua@kpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE
On 01-09-2026, one person namely Neel Kanth S/O Gopi Chand R/O Banjal Batwal Tehsil Lohai Malhar lodged a written report at P/S Billawar stating therein that on 29-08-2026 his son namely Sunil Kumar, age 28 years went missing from Bus Stand Billawar and did not return back home till date. The complainant made best efforts to search his son but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 15 dated 01-09-2026 has been entered at Police Station Billawar. During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas he is still un-traced.
As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about his whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably-
PHOTOGRAPH
Description Roll:-

- Name : Sunil Kumar
- Father : Neel Kanth
- Permanent Address : Banjal Batwal
- Present Address : Banjal Batwal
- Tehsil : Lohai Malhar
- Police Station : Billawar
- Age : 28 years
- Height : 5 feet 03 inch
- Complexion : Wheatish
- Built : Normal
- Face : Oval
- Eyes : Black

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

- DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
- dpokathua@kpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
- PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
- Police Station Billawar 9186316020

DIP/J-9981/26, Sep 09 2026
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@kpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191
SHO P/S Domana, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Satish Kumar S/O Om Parkash R/O Roop Nagar Sector No. 02, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 125/2004 U/S 279/337 RPC of P/S Domana, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.
Description Roll :-
Name : Satish Kumar
S/O : Om Parkash
Address : Roop Nagar Sector No. 02, Jammu
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

- DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
- SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@kpolice.gov.in
- PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
- SP Rural : 0191-2605949
- SDPO Domana : 0191-2604220
- P/S Domana : 0191-2604214

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP/J- 9901/26 Sep 9 2026



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@kpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191
SHO P/S Domana, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Ranbir Singh alias Bittu S/O Shanker Singh R/O Kogh Mandli Billawar Kathua is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 209/2004 U/S 420/201 RPC , of P/S Domana, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.
Description Roll :-
Name : Ranbir Singh alias Bittu
S/O : Shanker Singh
Address : Kogh Mandli Billawar Kathua
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

- DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
- SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@kpolice.gov.in
- PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
- SP Rural : 0191-2605949
- SDPO Domana : 0191-2604220
- P/S Domana : 0191-2604214

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP/J- 9903/26 Sep 9 2026



JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@kpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191
SHO P/S Nagrota, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Javeed Ahmed S/O Ghulam Rasool R/O Malik Market Rajouri A/P Narwal Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 314/2007 U/279/337/338 RPC of P/S Nagrota, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded. It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.
Description Roll :-
Name : Javeed Ahmed
S/O : Ghulam Rasool
Address : Malik Market Rajouri A/P Narwal Jammu
Age : 43 years
Height : 5' 7"
Complexion : Wheatish
Eyes : Brown
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

- DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
- SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@kpolice.gov.in
- PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
- SP Rural Jammu : 0191-2605949
- SDPO Nagrota : 0191-2673666
- SHO P/S Nagrota : 0191-2673025

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP/J- 10024/26 Sep 10 2026



Tamilnadu Police Housing Corporation Ltd
(A Government of Tamil Nadu Undertaking)
(AN ISO 9001 - 2015 CERTIFIED COMPANY)
North Circle
No. 1 & 7, Inspector Quarters, PCR Line, Behind CPO Building, Annadhanapatty, Linemedu, Salem - 636 006.
email id: sentnphcl@gmail.com & spndengrnc.tnphcl@tn.gov.in Phone: 0427-2903010

e-Tender Invitation for Bid No: 10 / 2026-2027 **Dated: 10.09.2026**

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Approximate value of work in Lakhs
1	Construction of Special Prison for Women and Prison Staff Quarters (6 Nos. of Deputy Jailor, 10 Nos. of Assistant Jailor and 220 Nos. of Jail Warder Quarters) with development works and Security perimeter wall (Phase I & II) at Billuchi Village, Coimbatore North Taluk in Coimbatore District. (SE/NC/DB/2247/2026)	₹ 9753.65 + GST @ 18%

- For Tender document, visit <https://tntenders.gov.in>
- Date and Time for downloading and submission of tender documents: **25.09.2026 from 12.00 Noon to 28.10.2026 upto 6.00 P.M.**
- Date and time of opening of the e-tender: **30.10.2026 at 11.15A.M.**
- Detailed Tender Notice is available in the website www.tnphc.com & www.tnphc.gov.in
Superintending Engineer, North Circle, TNPHC Ltd

DIPR/2829/Tender/2026



Indira Gandhi Institute of Cardiology
(under Government of Bihar)
Patna Medical College Campus, Ashok Rajpatti, Patna-800004
(NIT) REFERENCE NO: 04/2026-27

SRL NO	PROCEDURE NAME	EMD AMMOUNT	PERFORMANCE SECURITY	REMARKS I	REMARKS II	REMARKS III
1	PTCA+ STENTING	RS. 1,00,000/-	The successful bidder shall have to furnish a performance security, 5% to 10% of the contract value, which they earned from Supplying Institute from One Financial Year, as per Bihar Financial Rules (BFR). In the shape of a Bank Guarantee issued by a scheduled Bank in favour of Institute. The Bank guarantee shall be as per performance and remain valid for a period, which is six months beyond the date of expiry of the contract. The Performance Security will be returned to the bidder, upon validation of completion of the all contractual obligations including warranty.	RATE CONTRACT FOR I. SELF-FINANCED PATIENTS	BASIS OF THE PRICE QUOTED FOR PROCEDURE WISE.	3. BIDDER MUST BE CLEARLY MENTIONED (EG. - GROUP-A, GROUP-B ETC.) ON THE COVERING ENVELOPE FOR PARTICIPATING GROUP FOR CLEARLY KNOWING THAT FOR WHICH ITEMS BIDDER IS PARTICIPATING. 4. TENDERER NEEDS TO BE DEPOSIT THE AS CUMULATIVE TOTAL EMD AMOUNT FOR PARTICIPATING IN GROUPS AS PER HIS CHOICE AS MENTIONED IN THE SHAPE OF DEMAND DRAFT (DD) FROM ANY SCHEDULE BANK IN FAVOUR OF DIRECTOR, INDIRA GANDHI INSTITUTE OF CARDIOLOGY, PATNAB. 5. PRICE OF EACH ITEM WILL BE CONSIDERED SEPARATELY.
2	CORONARY ANGIOGRAPHY (FEMORAL ROUTE)					
3	BAY (BALLOON PULMONARY VALVOTOMY)					
4	BAY (BALLOON AORTIC VALVOTOMY)					
5	DISTAL ARTERY EMBOLECTOMY (PERIPHERAL / RINAL / BRONCHIAL) WITH COIL OR PVC PARTICLES					
6	COARCTATION OF THE AORTA - COARCTATION DILATATION WITH STENT					
7	POA COIL CLOSURE: SINGLE COIL					
8	POA COIL CLOSURE: MULTIPLE COIL					
9	PERIPHERAL ANGIOPLASTY					
9	MISC. ELLENANEOUS ITEMS					

SNO	EVENT DESCRIPTION	TIMELINE
1	CLOSING, DATE & TIME OF RECEIPT OF TENDER	30-09-2026 AT 12:00 NOON
2	PRE-BID MEETING	16-09-2026 AT 12:00 NOON
3	TIME, DATE AND VENUE OF OPENING OF TECHNICAL BID / FINANCIAL BID.	TO BE COMMUNICATED BY THE INSTITUTE

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
Director,
Indira Gandhi Institute of Cardiology, Patna
PR- 011507 (Health) 2026-27
नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।



बिहार सरकार
विज्ञान, प्रौद्योगिकी एवं तकनीकी शिक्षा विभाग
Department of Science, Technology & Technical Education
राजकीय पोलिटेक्निक सिवान
स्थित-बावन्दीह, चैनपुर-841203
GOVERNMENT POLYTECHNIC, SIWAN
Situatd at - Bawandih , P. O - Chainpur
Email Id - principalpgsiwan@gmail.com
WALK-IN INTERVIEW (NATS)

Government Polytechnic Siwan invites eligible candidates for National Apprenticeship Training Scheme (NATS) trainee for the following branch & departments:

SN	Branch	Discipline	Total Vacancy	Stipend/Month
1	COMPUTER SC. & ENGG. / COMPUTER SCIENCE	B.E / B.TECH / B.S.C. / Diploma	06	As per Government Order.
2	CIVIL ENGG.			
3	ELECTRICAL ENGG.			
4	ELECTRONICS ENGG.			
5	MECHANICAL ENGG.			
6	PHYSICS / CHEMISTRY			

Candidates are supposed to come for walk-in- Interview with following Original Certificates:-
1. Degree/Diploma, +2 certificate, mark sheets, Transfer certificate/CLC and Adhar Card.
2. Community certificate in case of SC/ST/OBC/PH candidate.
3. One set of self attested photocopies of all certificates.
4. Affidavit for not admitted/enrolled in other Institutes and not working elsewhere.
5. It is mandatory for the candidates to have NATS Student's Id.
* Reservation Policy will be followed as per regulation of Government of Bihar / India.
* There is no Provision of TA/DA for this interview.
Venue - Government Polytechnic Siwan
At Bawandih, Chainpur-841203
Date & Reporting Timing - 15/09/2026 (TUESDAY) @ 11:00 A: M
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar
NATS INCHARGE **PRINCIPAL**
Government Polytechnic Siwan Government Polytechnic Siwan
PR. No. 011558 (Sci. & Tech.) 2026-27
नशामुक्त हो जाए बिहार, सुरक्षित रहे घर परिवार।

Himachal Pradesh
Jal Shakti Vibhag
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Online bids on item rate basis are invited by the Executive Engineer, Jal Shakti Division, Mandi HP- 175001 on behalf of the Governor of Himachal Pradesh, in electronic tendering system in two covers for the under mentioned work from the contractors/ firms of appropriate class enlisted with H.P. Jal Shakti Vibhag.

1.	Revised Augmentation of Sewerage Scheme Mandi Town and providing sewerage facility to adjoining villages of Mandi Town in Distt. Mandi (HP) (SH-C/O Wet Well 0.04 MLD at Police Colony Bhiuli, 0.071 MLD at Bhiuli near Bangali Basti Bhiuli, 0.030 MLD at Bhiuli near Bhimkali Temple, 0.020 MLD at Pulgharat & 0.138 MLD at Bhiuli near Riverdale Colony. Improvement of R/wall existing Wet Well 0.025 MLD near Homegarad Ground at Bhiuli along with Pumping Machinery, DG Set and allied accessories along with automation & Providing and laying Rising Main 100 mm dia=1720 Rmt at various places & C/O Inlet Chamber, Construction of Screen Chamber, Providing Electrical installation to Pump House).	1,67,92,324/-	2,43,000/-	5000/-	Six Months
2.	Revised Augmentation of Sewerage Scheme Mandi Town and providing sewerage facility to adjoining villages of Mandi Town in Distt. Mandi (HP) (SH-C/O Wet Well 1.50 MLD Near KV School Khaliyar and Providing and Laying Rising Main from Wet Well to STP Khaliyar DI pipe double flanged pipe of 200 mm dia K9=760 Rmt along with Pumping Machinery, DG Set and allied accessories along with automation, C/O RCC Piller, C/O Inlet Chamber, Construction of Screen Chamber, Providing Electrical installation to Pump House and Construction of Steel Truss Crossing at Khaliyar).	2,31,45,880/-	3,06,500/-	5000/-	Six Months
3.	Construction of Training Centre for Jal Shakti Employees at Dhangsidhar Distt Mandi HP (SH- C/O R/Wall Left side of Block B Hostel Building at Dhangsidhar from RD 10.50 to 16.40 = 5.90, Back side of Kitchen from RD 0 to 13.40 = 13.40 Mtr and C/O RCC Slab of Kitchen of Faculty Accommodation at Dhangsidhar) Deposit Work.	15,82,326/-	31800/-	500/-	Three Months

The Key dates for e-tender are as under:	
1. Date of publication	07-09-2026 at 06.00 PM
2. Downloading of e-tender Documents	07-09-2026 at 06.00 PM
3. Bid Submission start date	07-09-2026 at 06.00 PM upto 17-09-2026 at 05.00 PM
4. Bid Submission end date	17-09-2026 at 05.00 PM
5. Opening of Eligibility criteria & Technical Information (Cover-I)	On 18-09-2026 at 11.00 AM
6. Opening of Financial bid (Cover-II)	Date and place to be notified separately.

The instructions for e-tendering are as per point no. 20 Forms Applicable- Form No. 6 & 8
AVAILABILITY OF FORMS:
2. Tenders are to be submitted only on PWD forms/BOQ and can be downloaded from the web-site <https://tntenders.gov.in>. As the bids are to be submitted online are required to be encrypted and digitally signed. The bidders are advised to obtain Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) from suitable vendors or from an authorized agency at the earliest.
3. The documents consisting of the detailed specification, schedule of quantities of various items of work, and the set of conditions to be complied with can be downloaded or viewed online from the portal <https://tntenders.gov.in> on the date(s) & time given above by the firms/ individual registered on the website, which is free of cost.
Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division Mandi.
HP / 3228/26-27 **him suchana avam jan sampark**



KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-35/1507/2026-27 **Date: 08.09.2026**
SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)
Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :
Name of the Work: Formation of Roads including asphaltting, construction of RCC Side Drains, Inspection Chambers, Spur Culverts, Valve Cistern, Rain Water Harvesting & Water Supply Works at Sector-2 of Gowribidnur 4th Phase in Jarabandanahalli Village, Gowribidnur Taluk, Chikkaballapura District (2nd call). The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **19.09.2026 upto 4.00 pm.**
Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.
Sd/-
Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru
DIPR/CP/2671/SMCL/2026-27

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Call our toll-free number
1800 102 1878

Or write to us at
customercare@thehindu.co.in

THE HINDU
FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR young world THE HINDU

Scan the QR code to register your feedback

लोकप्रिय गोपीनाथ बरदलै क्षेत्रीय मानसिक स्वास्थ्य संस्थान
तेजपुर: असम: पिन: 784001

LGB REGIONAL INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH
(An Autonomous institute under Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Govt. of India)
Website: www.lgbrimh.gov.in,
e - Mail: mail@lgbrimh.gov.in
Post Box No. 15:: FAX No.(03712) 233623
TEZPUR :: 784001 :: ASSAM

LGB/NAZ/4060/26/5195 **Dated - 07-09-2026**

REQUEST FOR QUALIFICATION (RFQ) NOTICE

The Director, Lokopriya Gopinath Bordoloi Regional Institute of Mental Health (LGBRIMH), Tezpur, invites Requests for Qualification (RFQ) from experienced and financially sound agencies/firms/companies/consortia for establishment, operation and maintenance of a CT Scan facility within the Institute premises on Public-Private Partnership (PPP) basis, with patient charges not exceeding the applicable Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS) rates. The last date of RFQ submission is 28.09.2026. For more details log on to www.lgbrimh.gov.in or <http://eprocure.gov.in/eppp>

Director
LGBRIMH

CBC17179/11/0017/2627

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION
Office of the Executive Engineer, Byatarayanapura Division, Zone-1 No. 2152/20, Defence colony, 9th Main, D Block, Sahakaranagara, BNCC office, Bengaluru-560092.
No:BNCC-Z1/EE/BTP/KPPP/PR/20/2026-27 Date: 09-09-2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION

(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
Tenders on item rate basis are invited by the undersigned on behalf of The Commissioner, BNCC for the works mentioned below from the registered contractors of Bengaluru North City Corporation, or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD / Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations. (Standard Tender Document KW-1,2,3,4)

Sl. No.	Name of the work / Category (TWO COVER TENDER)
1.	Annual Maintenance of SWD in Byatarayanapura Division for the year 2026-27. Call-8 (OTHERS) Approximate value of work: ₹.175.00 Lakhs, EMD: ₹.262500/-

Calendar of Events: (1) Pre-bid meeting will be held on **15-09-2026** at **3:00 pm**. (2) Last Date for uploading the filled proposals on **21-09-2026** upto **4:00 pm**. (3) Date of Opening of Technical Bid is **23-09-2026** after **11:00 am**. (4) Date of Opening of Financial Bid After Approval of Technical Bid.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
Byatarayanapura Division, Zone-1,
Bengaluru North City Corporation

HP / 3235/26-27

Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division Mandi.

AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGICL)
2nd Floor, APCRDA Office, Rayapudi (P), Thulluru (M), Amaravati, Guntur (D), A.P-522237.

Rc. No. AGICL/HRD/Recruitments/2026 Dt:10.09.2026

EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION NO.7/2026

Notification is hereby issued for engagement of services in AGICL, Amaravati on Deputation/Contract basis. Online Application is available in the AGICL website in careers tab and can be submitted from **Dt. 11.09.2026 to 24.09.2026, 5.00 PM**. For further details pls visit <https://www.agicl.org>

S.No.	Name of the Post	No of Post Vacant
1.	Superintending Engineer (Civil)	1
2.	Executive Engineer (Civil)	1

Sd/- Managing Director (FAC), AGICL

Himachal Pradesh
Jal Shakti Vibhag
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

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2.	Revised Augmentation of Sewerage Scheme Mandi Town and providing sewerage facility to adjoining villages of Mandi Town in Dist. Mandi (HP) (SH:- C/O Wet Well 1.50 MLD Near KV School Khaliyar and Providing and Laying Rising Main from Wet Well to STP Khaliyar DI pipe double flanged pipe of 200 mm dia K9-760 Rmt along with Pumping Machinery, DG Set and allied accessories along with automation, C/O RCC Piller, C/O Inlet Chamber, Construction of Screen Chamber, Providing Electrical installation to Pump House and Construction of Steel Truss Crossing at Khaliyar).	2,31,45,880/-	3,06,500/-	5000/-	Six Months
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The Key dates for e-tender are as under:

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6.	Opening of Financial bid (Cover-II)	Date and place to be notified separately.	

The instructions for e-tendering are as per point no. 20
Forms Applicable:- Form No. 6 & 8
AVAILABILITY OF FORMS:
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Executive Engineer,
Jal Shakti Division Mandi.

THANK YOU
For Being Part Of The Journey

To every filmmaker, artist, jury member, guest, partner, volunteer, and audience member who made IFFJK 2026 unforgettable.
Thank you for celebrating cinema and culture with us.

1,184
FILMS SUBMITTED

120
FILMS SCREENED

17
MASTERCLASSES & DISCUSSIONS

91
COUNTRIES' FILM SUBMISSIONS

6,600+
VISITORS ACROSS THE FESTIVAL

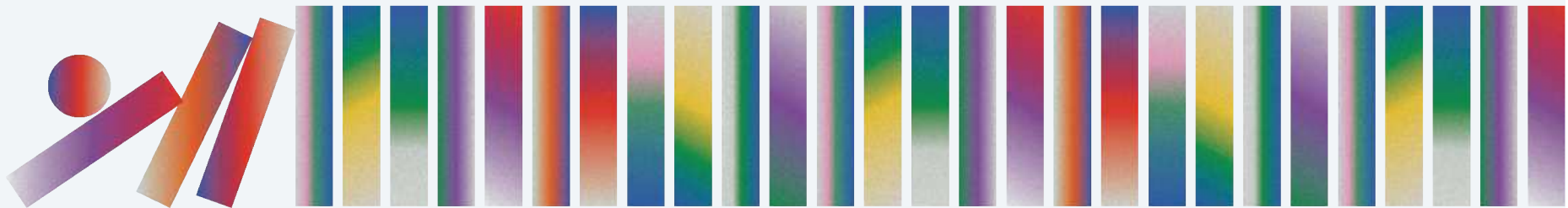
It was more than a festival.
IT WAS A SHARED JOURNEY

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Directorate of Information and Public Relations, J&K

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CHIEF GUEST

Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman
Honourable Minister of Finance and Corporate Affairs, Government of India



Scan the QR code or visit thbl.news/BLCM2026 to subscribe and watch the event.

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SPOTLIGHT



Tents set up at Magh Mela 2026 in Uttar Pradesh in January this year. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Faith travels first class

Pilgrimages across India are shifting from hardship to high-end comfort, fuelled by massive infrastructure projects, connectivity, and luxury travel packages. This commercial boom has escalating environmental and climate risks, raising debates over public spending priorities, writes **Radheshyam Jadhav**. Travellers to sacred spaces, however, feel the merging of spirituality and comfort is the new yatra playbook

Vilas Shete, 69, and his wife, Ranjana, sit in numbing disbelief as news of the rising death toll flashes across their screens from Nepal. Just days before, the couple had been standing on that ground at Gyirong Port on the Nepal-China border, smiling for photographs. They had been on a pilgrimage to Mount Kailash and Lake Mansarovar. Now, the area is devastated, ravaged by a flood that even swept away the check post they had crossed.

The couple has been on many of India's well-known religious tours, including to the 12 Jyotirlingas, Shirdi, Char Dham, and Narmada Parikrama. Every time they step out for religious tours, especially in other States, it cost nearly ₹50,000.

Shete, a retired employee of the Maharashtra State Transport Corporation, lives in Pune and believes that religious tourism, especially in the mountains, takes you near nature and closer to God. He believes that without a spiritual component, tourism lacks fulfilment.

Travel companies, private groups, and spiritual sects that organise religious tours across India are now doing brisk business. With the Central government's push to develop infrastructure around places of religious interest, people's growing religiosity, and women's increasing mobility and money power, the demand for group tours in non-budget categories has increased. So has the supply. For instance, travel company Thomas Cook organises an "Ayodhya to Kashi Quick Bhakti Yatra with Taj stays" at over ₹1 lakh. For the Kumbh Mela in Uttar Pradesh, The Ultimate Travelling Camp offers "exclusive glamping packages" where "enlightenment meets extravagance". Several tour operators offer "spiritual luxury" or "VIP darshan" for Tirupati in Andhra Pradesh.

A 2025 report by consulting firm KPMG projected that India's spiritual tourism sector would grow at a Compound Annual Growth Rate of 18.2%. The Ministry of Tourism does not maintain specific data around the number of pilgrim visits across the country. However, the government has, in various Press Information Bureau handouts, said that spiritual tourism continues to attract millions of domestic and international visitors every year. India is home to some of the world's significant religions: Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, and Sikhism.

There is also no data on what slice of the spiritual market caters to tourists who opt for trips in the luxury or affordable luxury (bridging the mass to luxury market) segments. The pilgrimage to Mount Kailash and Lake Mansarovar, for instance, cost the Shetes ₹2.72 lakh each, but this can go up to ₹7 lakh, depending on the tour operator and route.

After China reopened the route after six years, and the first batch of pilgrims took the trip in 2025, Kailash-Manasarovar has become the latest spiritual destination that people flock to, in what is sometimes a lifelong quest to visit at least a few of India's spiritual destinations. While the



There is nothing wrong with seeking a peaceful, luxurious experience that offers mental peace, physical comfort, and an unhindered spiritual journey

YUVRAJ LAHOTI
Academician,
Pune

Kumbh Mela and the inauguration of the Ram Mandir pushed up the demand for spiritual tourism, pilgrimages have always been a part of India's cultural life.

What has changed is that the youth are also now opting for them. Also, "Group packages are surging in popularity, with women travelling in these groups, with or without their husbands," notes Gopal Bhatt, a Nainital-based tour operator and vehicle fleet owner.

Kathmandu scribe Krishna Adhikari, who has witnessed Nepal's socio-economic evolution over 30 years, notes a steady rise in Indian religious pilgrims over the last decade. "As the numbers are growing, the tourist companies, vehicle vendors, hotels, and other service providers are crowding into Kathmandu and also on the route to the pilgrimage places," says Adhikari.

According to the Hotel Association of India, 2025 reflected renewed confidence and strong demand in the hospitality sector, driven by spiritual tourism hotspots like Ayodhya, Jammu, Varanasi, Puri, Amritsar, and Tirupati, alongside the Maha Kumbh boosting Tier II and III markets. International arrivals along spiritual circuits grew steadily.

Divine access

Bengaluru-based Vrishali Balloli, a frequent religious traveller, in her early 50s, combined trekking with spirituality during a trip to Uttarakhand's Chamoli district in 2024. She visited the Valley of Flowers National Park, Gurdwara Hemkund Sahib, Badrinath, and Rishikesh.

Reflecting on the journey, she says, "My earlier trekking experiences were very good, but this time it was an out-of-this-world experience. My eyes overflowed as I experienced something divine during this journey."

Balloli's local group tour package costs ₹24,000, and her total trip costs about ₹40,000.

"Travelling to religious places has become easy and accessible, thanks to the Central government's efforts to connect religious corridors and improve connectivity," she adds.

The Union Ministry of Tourism's PRASHAD scheme provides financial assistance to State Governments and Union Territory Administrations to develop tourism-related infrastructure at identified religious and heritage sites. The government has sanctioned 54 projects across India, with an investment of ₹1,726.74 crore, focussing on infrastructure and visitor amenities.

Complementing this, the Swadesh Darshan scheme develops integrated tourism infrastructure across 15 thematic circuits, including Buddhist, Sufi, Himalayan, Krishna, and Ramayana. So far, 76 projects have been sanctioned and an investment of ₹5,290.33 crore has been made, as of March 2026.

"Across India, journeys of faith continue to draw millions of pilgrims every year. These sacred travels do more than deepen spiritual connections. They sustain local livelihoods, support traditional crafts and enterprises, and serve as important drivers of regional economic growth," the Government of India stated in an explainer titled 'A Decade of Tourism-Led Growth' published in June 2026.

Balloli is planning on more religious trips. "I want to visit as many religious places in India as possible in comfort, and now it is possible. Soon, I want to visit Mansarovar," she says, adding, "But I will complete the Char Dham Yatra first."

Peak pressure

Uttarakhand, known as Devbhoomi or the Land of Gods, welcomes devotees to numerous temples, most notably the Char Dham Yatra. This high-altitude Himalayan pilgrimage encompasses four holy sites: Yamunotri, Gangotri, Kedarnath, and Badrinath. Traditionally completed on foot in a clockwise direction beginning from Yamunotri, now, these are done by road or helicopter.

Dehradun-based Amogh Panwar, who is a hotelier, tour planner, and trekking organiser, and has been in the tourism industry since 1992, describes Uttarakhand's religious tourism as reaching a level of "madness." He calls it an all-in-one package featuring the Himalayas, adventure, spiritual sites, and facilities ranging from basic to five-star accommodation across a landscape supported by five luxury hotels, over 500 travel agents, and private helicopter service providers.

Offering options ranging from ₹40,000 to ₹2 lakh to ₹5 lakh per day, the sector is now seeing seniors opting for luxury itineraries which their children abroad pay for. Wealthy travellers frequently choose packages featuring helicopter services for quick darshans, sometimes clubbing them with birthdays or anniversaries in the Himalayas.

Char Dham helicopter operations – split between roughly nine shuttle companies and about 25 charter firms – generate a seasonal business exceeding ₹1,000 crore, says Panwar. Industry in-

siders warn that intense competition causes safety to take a back seat, as corners are cut and checks are skipped. A former operator and a former Nehru Institute of Mountaineering volunteer revealed that pilots are often incentivised to increase daily sorties, resulting in fatigue, rushed decisions, risky flights in unpredictable mountain weather, and minimal oversight regarding passenger limits or pricing.

Last year, Shraddha Jaiswal, her husband Rajkumar, and their two-year-old daughter Kashi travelled from Yavatmal, Maharashtra, to celebrate Shraddha's 35th birthday. They took a helicopter to Kedarnath. They were killed in the fifth helicopter crash in Uttarakhand within six weeks.

"The mountains are not built for business. With the rising number of tourists, the hills are being cut and nature is expressing its wrath again and again," says Kishan Singh, a taxi operator.

Singh notes a shift in mindset, recalling that earlier religious travellers believed enduring hardship and walking to destinations brought them closer to God, whereas today the opposite is true. "It is becoming difficult to recognise if the people coming here are spiritual or they just want to buy everything including the luxury and blessings by throwing money at the experience," an agitated Singh adds.

Social environmental activist Mushtaq Pahalgami, with The Himalaya Welfare Organization in Pahalgam, working for sustainable environment development in the region, says that the fragile Himalayas must be protected from any further haphazard development.

Pahalgam, in Jammu and Kashmir, sits among lofty mountains and evergreen forests, attracting domestic and international tourists. From here, people travel to the Amarnath Cave, located 72 kms from the district headquarters. Amidst the burgeoning traffic – 1.13 lakh people, reportedly, visited in the first five days of the 2026 season. Pahalgami says, locals are working hard to maintain the environment and hills as they are.

Pilgrimages of comfort

Once a tiny town of over 25,000 residents, Shirdi is now a global religious tourism destination centred around the Sai Baba temple. Resident Satish Vajapurkar, who attributes much of the town's early growth boost to late actor Manoj Kumar's 1977 film *Shirdi ke Sai Baba*, notes that daily footfall reaches about 40,000, soaring to 1 lakh during celebrations in a landscape of over 150 luxury hotels.

"We have to maintain the infrastructure and services at international standards as people from across the world come here. We have found currencies of 26 countries in the donation box at the temple," he says.

Supported by regular VIP visits, an airport, and luxury travel companies, the rising number of visitors has boosted Shirdi's economy. The official records with the temple show that for the financial year 2024-25, the total annual income of the Shree Saibaba Sansthan Trust, Shirdi, stood at ₹850.62 crore. Investments in bank fixed deposits were ₹3,918 crore, as of March 31, 2025.

Academician Yuvraj Lahoti from Pune, says he wants to look at temples beyond Maharashtra now. "I have added Ayodhya to my itinerary. There are groups which now go monthly or twice a month (from Pune)," he says, adding that Ayodhya provides good infrastructure and a streamlined darshan. He notes that the idea of enduring a torturous journey as part of spirituality is a thing of the past. "There is nothing wrong with seeking a peaceful, luxurious experience that offers mental peace, physical comfort, and an unhindered spiritual journey," he adds.

He adds that the experience at Varanasi's Shri Kashi Vishwanath Temple corridor is excellent compared to his earlier visits, proving that comfort, easy access, and a hassle-free environment are essential for modern temple-goers.

Balaji Murumbe, a professional from Latur, in his late 20s, who recently visited Tirupati to resolve personal challenges ranging from marriage hurdles to financial strain, notes that religious tourism serves a dual purpose by offering routine breaks with a deeper search for meaning. Observing trends within his own travel circle, including a Gujarati couple making regular trips to Tirupati to seek blessings for a child, Murumbe says that annual or semi-annual vacations have become synonymous with religious tourism.

The Maharashtra government has planned an expenditure of ₹34,000 crore to develop infrastructure and hospitality for the 2027 Simhastha Kumbh Mela in Maharashtra's Nashik city.

Supreme Court judge Justice Prasanna Varale observed at a public event that if even 0.1% of the Kumbh allocation had been spent on Marathi-medium schools, more than 100 schools could have been saved from closure. The education budget, he said, is shrinking.

However, Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis says that 93% of the Kumbh allocation was being invested in permanent infrastructure that would benefit Nashik for the next 50 years. As the Kumbh nears, the State government hopes to welcome crores of devotees not only for the Kumbh but also to reassert that Lord Hanuman was born in Anjaneri near Nashik and not in Kishkinda in Karnataka.

Rashmi Jain, a sociologist and Vice-Chancellor at the University of Technology in Jaipur, in Rajasthan, notes that this period is marked by both, a newly developed urge to reconnect with roots and culture, and the social media pressure to be seen. "Several forces have converged here, alongside narratives crafted by spiritual leaders and *katha vachaks* (religious storytellers), drawing the youth. Remote religious sites are now made accessible with modern connectivity, driving the new era of religious luxury tourism".

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Kailash Manasarovar yatris gather at Nathu La Pass after Sikkim Governor Om Prakash Mathur flagged off the first batch of pilgrims on June 20, 2026. PTI



Deepali Dhingra

A striking 19th-Century tiger mask and a brass breastplate from Karnataka greet visitors at the entrance of the newly opened Sanskriti Museum of Everyday Art & Indian Textiles. Located within the Humayun's Tomb World Heritage Site Museum in Delhi, these pieces offer a fascinating preview of the living traditions, regional master craftsmanship, and rich cultural tapestries preserved within.

The new gallery showcases a legendary collection of over 1,000 artifacts and textiles assembled over five decades by OP Jain, founder of the Sanskriti Museums. The exhibits range from betel nut crackers, children's toys, and writing instruments to lamps, combs, and kitchen utensils. Complementing these objects is a vast collection of Indian textiles, including bandhani from Rajasthan, kani shawls from Kashmir, and phulkaris from Punjab, among others from across the country.

The collection was gifted by the Sanskriti Board of Trustees to the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA), with display design and execution handled by the Aga Khan Trust for Culture (AKTC), which co-manages the exhibition

The art of the ordinary

Delhi's Sanskriti Museum of Everyday Art & Indian Textiles brings OP Jain's legendary collection of artefacts to life

space. The curation inside follows a life-cycle approach, with the first display dedicated to childhood and artefacts for play. Beautifully adorned cradles and painted wooden walkers are displayed inside vitrines. With education as the next category, the display shows writing instruments such as ornate pens, brass ink pots, Kashmiri papier-mâché pen cases and wooden slates. Tools for work follow, and on the shelf, bronze rice measures from eastern India sit beside ornamental locks and latches. The kitchen section is extensive, with utensils made of wood, brass, iron, marble and sandstone among others. Who knew a simple kitchen item, such as a chakla-belan, could

hold its own when it came to craftsmanship! But here it sits, next to intricately crafted butter churners and mortar-pestles.

The women's beauty section has foot scrubbers with peacock handles, hairpins and combs with motifs of women figurines and slender containers for kajal and vermilion. The artefacts in this display capture the elegance and functionality of everyday beauty objects. A display of boxes shows the sheer variety used in Indian homes,



Circle of life The display and exhibits at Sanskriti Museum; (below) Humayun's Tomb. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



including wooden boxes inlaid with ivory, simpler ones with lids, and artefacts of use in religious ritual and home shrines that remind one of the past. An entire glass display is dedicated to lotas or sculptural pots, and for good reason.

Looking back

Archana Saad Akhtar, programme director, Design, AKTC shares that when renowned American designers Charles and Ray Eames were invited by Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru to visit



India in the late 1950s to set up a design school in India, the designers were fascinated by the lota and how design, form and function come together beautifully in them – an observation they documented in their India Report which led to the formation of the National Institute of Design.

The museum space is also peppered with samples of Indian textiles from across the country. Alongside the display, one can read about the craft as well as about the specific samples showcased. The border of a Baluchari saree from West Bengal is adorned with 'Vande Mataram' embroidered in Bengali; elsewhere, the unique tapestry weaving technique of a kani shawl from Kashmir is on display. "If we don't safeguard these traditional textile techniques now, the knowledge of how to create them will disappear," says Archana.

As one exits the museum, one can't help but gaze in admiration at the monumental clay horses and elephants from the Ayyanar terracotta traditions of from Tamil Nadu, displayed in the courtyard – also a gift of the Sanskriti Foundation.

The Sanskriti Museum gallery is open from 10am to 6pm on all days except Mondays. Entry is priced at ₹50.

STEP OUT



Between worlds

At India Habitat Centre, artist and architect Vasant Dora explores the relationship between the built and the spiritual in Aaveg: Between the Finite and the Infinite, curated by Jyoti A Kathpalia. The exhibition brings together Habitat Scapes, inspired by urban spaces and architecture, and Samsara, reflecting on the eternal cycle of existence through Shiva and Shakti, purusha, and prakriti. Till tomorrow, from 10am to 8pm, at Visual Arts Gallery, India Habitat Centre.



City as art

DAG's art and heritage festival, The City as a Museum, returns to Delhi for its second edition from September 12 to 25. The festival brings together exhibitions, talks, walks, workshops, and performances across historic institutions and neighbourhoods. Highlights include Vision and Landscape, featuring aquatints by Thomas and William Daniell. For the full calender and timings visit dagworld.com.

True to roots

Chandigarh's Karthik South Indian Restaurant has maintained its dedication to authentic Tamil cuisine

Nacchinarkkiniyan M

Nine out of his 10 customers are North Indian. Gunasekaran P still refuses to sweeten the sambar.

At four in the morning, when Chandigarh's grid of sectors is still a diagram of empty roundabouts, the lights come on in a kitchen in Sector 46. By seven the first idlis are off the steamer. "When we came here, hotels opened at 11 in the morning," says Gunasekaran P, 43, founder of Karthik South Indian Restaurant. "Now many others also open early."

It was 1994, and he was in Class VI in Mallankinaru, a village in Virudhunagar district, where the rain is a rumour and the only prospects were farming and the matchbox industry. Drought had settled in, and the family decided Delhi would take him. He arrived in Lajpat Nagar to one of the hundred-odd South Indian hotels run by men from his district. He began as a dishwasher, and for seven years, was not allowed to cook.

Then one day the master did not turn up. When the hotel was desperate, the dishwasher stepped up to the stove and cooked as though he had been doing it for years. He left the hotel in 2004. At the time, his salary was ₹300.

The idea of Chandigarh came from a customer-turned-friend – the city had few South Indian hotels, a steady

demand for the cuisine, and a Tamil population already decades old. On October 27, 2005, a roadside eatery selling idli, dosa and vada opened in Sector 46. The second came in 2012.

The sambar argument

"For the first six or seven years, it was very difficult," Gunasekaran says. "Customers would say this is not the taste they get in other South Indian hotels." They said, *spicy bahut hai*. Gunasekaran adjusted, but only so far. No garlic. No onion. Less chilli than a Tamil household would use. The result still tastes of Tamil Nadu. His brother, Surendran P, has blended the masalas for two decades, grinding them in-house. Almost everything else travels from Tamil Nadu – rice, appalam and banana leaves from Madurai; coconut from Pollachi; wood-pressed oil from Virudhunagar; filter coffee from Chennai.

Rajendar Prasad, a retired Union Government employee, and his wife Rajini have been coming here for 20 years. "It is light food. Even children who won't touch vegetables will eat them in sambar. Punjabi food is heavier."

Twenty years after opening his first roadside eatery, most of Gunasekaran's customers are still not Tamil. The boy who was not allowed to cook now decides what a city eats for breakfast.



Vanakkam Chandigarh Gunasekaran P, 43, founder of Karthik South Indian Restaurant. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



Memoirs of another time The author Pankaj at the book launch. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Courting justice

In his book, Pankaj revisits his arrest, time in prison, the eventual acquittal, and the personal cost of a 14-year legal battle

Geetika Sachdev

For much of his career, Pankaj was on the other side of the law. When he became the Assistant Provident Fund Commissioner in 1994, his work placed him at the intersection of labour rights and enforcement.

Over the years, he led action against employers accused of defaulting on provident fund dues and exploitative practices, including enforcement drives involving factory workers, weavers and daily wage labourers. Some of his operations involved powerful industrialists and corporate houses.

Today, as Additional Central Provident Fund Commissioner (HQ), he heads EPFO's public

grievances vertical at the national level. He also spearheads Nidhi Aapke Nikat, EPFO's nationwide district outreach initiative, and has headed its publicity and communication division.

How it unfolded

But between those two points in his career lies the experience that became the subject of his book, *My Lady in Black: Learning the laws to fight the flaws*,



It was very difficult. Once you are accused, it is headline material while acquittal is like a footnote

PANKAJ Additional Central Provident Fund Commissioner



published by PenManush, and already picked up for a film adaptation.

On June 22, 2006, Pankaj became the target of what he describes as a conspiracy arising from personal vendetta and carried out through the machinery of law enforcement. What followed was a 14-year legal battle, including two months in Hotwar jail, a chargesheet that he says relied on fabricated testimony and a sanction order invoking a provision of law that did not exist. The case eventually ended in his acquittal. "It was very difficult. Once you are trapped, you are condemned," he says.

The book, launched at India Habitat Centre on August 30, in the presence of senior civil servants, members of the judiciary, and journalists, is based on true incidents, with some creative liberties. "Once you are accused, it is headline material while acquittal is like a footnote," he adds.

At the heart of the book is his wife, Sweta, whose role during those years inspired its title. An MBA in Finance who returned to university to study Law, she examined the case closely and pursued its legal complexities as the battle continued. "What my wife did was next to impossible," says Pankaj. "Studying something that was alien just to get me past this hardship."

He recalls a moment during the trial when the Public Prosecutor kept asking leading questions. Sweta pursued the issue, studied it and continued fighting and petitioning.

What prison taught him

His two months in prison became another unexpected chapter of the experience. Pankaj describes encountering what he calls the "dark underbelly of society", meeting undertrials, convicts and people accused of serious crimes.

Yet prison also challenged some of his assumptions about those he encountered. He met prisoners who were keen to learn English and others who aspired to become MPs or MLAs.

The experience, he says, made him look at society differently. It also gave him a perspective on people and institutions that he could not have acquired from the other side of the system.

Writing the book became a way of processing those years. "It was cathartic to write the book," he says.

But acquittal did not erase the years that preceded it. For Pankaj, that is ultimately what *My Lady in Black* seeks to preserve: not merely the legal record of a case, but the emotional cost of living under an accusation for years. "Justice wins but costs you a lot," he says.



M ND-NDE

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Emergency World Bank funds to be received by Kenya

400 in \$ million. Kenya is expected to receive about \$400 million in emergency financing from the World Bank within six weeks to help address risks including an Ebola outbreak in the region and El Niño-related disruptions, a source familiar with the matter said. REUTERS

Percentage increase in Equity MF inflows in August

19 in per cent. Equity mutual fund schemes attracted ₹29,329 crore in August, registering a highest net inflow in four months, as investors continued to favour mid- and small-cap funds. This inflow was nearly 19% higher than the ₹24,697 crore recorded in July. PTI

Persons killed after cargo ship catches fire in China's port

20 A cargo ship docked for repairs in a Chinese port caught fire, killing at least 20 people and leaving five others missing, Chinese state media reported Thursday. The ship was being repaired in the Beihai Shipbuilding Co. at the port of Qingdao, a major shipping hub. AP

Amount transferred to beneficiaries under 26 schemes in Haryana

1,890 in ₹ crore. Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday transferred ₹1,890.16 crore directly into the bank accounts of more than 50 lakh eligible beneficiaries under 26 different schemes through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT). PTI

People affected in 14 districts as floods wreak havoc in Bihar

43 in lakh. More than 43 lakh people have been affected by floods in 14 districts of Bihar, with several rivers flowing above the danger mark, officials said. Incessant rain in several parts has caused rivers and streams to overflow, they said. PTI
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How should RUPPs be regulated?

Why do some RUPPs remain active despite poor compliance? How can their misuse be curbed? What can be done to improve transparency? Should RUPPs face a vote threshold for tax breaks? How can the EC act against non-serious parties?

EXPLAINER

Rangarajan R.

The story so far:

A ‘BBC News Hindi’ investigation has revealed that six Registered Unrecognised Political Parties (RUPP), all based in Gujarat, had received donations of around ₹1,700 crores for the year 2023-24. This is higher than the total received by five nationally recognised political parties, except the BJP, for the same period, which stood at ₹1,480 crores.

What are registered parties?

Political parties are an association or body of individuals that can be formed by citizens. Section 29A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951 (RP Act) lays down the requirements for registration of a political party with the Election Commission (EC). After satisfactory scrutiny of the documents submitted, the EC registers a political party as a RUPP. The RUPPs enjoy the following benefits – (a) tax exemption for donations received under Section 12 of the Income Tax Act, 2025, (b) common symbol for contesting general elections to the Lok Sabha/State Assemblies, and (c) 20 ‘star campaigners’ during election campaign. The RUPPs are required to maintain the details of individual donors above twenty thousand rupees in a financial year and submit them to the poll body every year. As per section 29C of the Representation of the People Act, failure to furnish these details will result in losing income tax exemption.

The RUPPs, under the Income Tax Act, 2025, are required to accept donations in excess of two thousand rupees only through cheque or bank transfers.

What are the issues?

As per the EC notification, India had more than 2,800 RUPPs as of July, but only around 750 contested the 2024 general elections. This has resulted in the moniker – ‘letter pad parties’ – for the rest of the RUPPs. The RP Act does not



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confer explicit powers on the EC to de-register a political party if it fails to contest elections, conduct inner-party elections, or lodge requisite returns. In the *Indian National Congress vs Institute of Social Welfare & Ors* (2002), the Supreme Court held that the EC does not have the power to de-register any political party under the RP Act. It may de-register only under exceptional circumstances, such as registration obtained by fraud, the political party ceasing to have allegiance to the Constitution, or being declared unlawful by the government. The EC periodically publishes the list of de-listed RUPPs. The October 2025 notification contains over 800 such parties.

However, the six RUPPs – Aam Janmat Party, Bharatiya National Janata Dal, Garib Kalyan Party, New India United Party, Satyawadi Rakshak Party and the Swatantrata Abhiviyakti Party – remain on the list of active RUPPs as per the EC notification in October 2025. This is because they managed to field a total of 15 candidates during the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. The Association for Democratic

Reforms periodically publishes reports on the status of submission of annual reports of RUPPs. In its July 2025 report, in which the annual reports of 2022-23 are analysed, it is stated that reports of only 26% of RUPPs are available in the public domain. Poor compliance with statutory requirements, coupled with a lack of transparency, results in these ‘letter pad’ parties being used as an opaque channel for tax evasion and money laundering.

What needs to be done?

The Law Commission, in its 255th report, had recommended amendments for de-registration of a political party if it fails to contest elections for ten consecutive years. The EC, in its memorandum for electoral reforms (2016), also suggested an amendment to the RP Act that would empower it to de-register a party. These are long-pending reforms that need to be carried out to empower the EC to act against non-serious parties, some of which are merely a façade for illegal financial transactions.

However, if parties contest elections

merely to fulfil a statutory requirement, they could continue to misuse their tax exemptions and be used for money laundering and other nefarious activities. In the present digital world, it is not difficult for the Income Tax Department and other enforcement agencies to monitor the transactions of such parties and take strict action against any wrongdoing. This would act as a deterrent against the misuse of the benefits and exemptions available to political parties. The EC had also suggested that tax exemptions be provided only for political parties that win seats in Lok Sabha or Legislative Assembly elections. This can be viewed as an undemocratic and extreme measure, as there are parties that consistently contest elections without electoral success. Instead, similar to the 1% vote threshold for allotting common symbols to RUPPs, a suitable vote percentage threshold may be stipulated by law for RUPPs to avail of tax exemptions on donations received.

(Rangarajan R. is a former IAS officer. Views expressed are personal)

THE GIST

▼ Six Gujarat-based RUPPs received about ₹1,700 crore in donations in 2023-24, raising concerns over opaque political funding

▼ Weak statutory provisions and poor compliance allow many non-serious RUPPs to remain active and potentially misuse tax exemptions

▼ The EC needs stronger powers to de-register such parties, while a suitable vote threshold could determine eligibility for tax exemptions

Why are Volkswagen and JLR trimming their workforce?

European carmakers are falling behind their Chinese counterparts in the race to corner the EV market

G. R. Rajeev

The story so far:

The German carmaker Volkswagen and the British marquee brand Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) are shedding jobs – the former deciding to axe 50,000 positions and the Tata-owned brand 4,000. The latest cut will reduce Volkswagen’s employee count by a lakh by the end of the decade, as the company had already reached agreements with employees since the end of 2024 to cut 50,000 jobs.

European carmakers have fallen behind Chinese manufacturers in the race to transition to electric vehicles and want to be shipshape in navigating the challenging terrain.

In July, BMW revealed its decision to cut its workforce by 8,000. Nifty homegrown brands are blocking Volkswagen’s traffic in the lucrative Chinese market, and the company, under

its chief executive, Oliver Blume, is taking a hard look at its worldwide operations, especially in the German market.

How have the two carmakers reached a settlement to cut jobs?

By no means has it been a smooth drive for the two giants who thrived in the heyday of internal combustion engines. Volkswagen had to contend with its powerful union to get approval for what many say is the most eventful restructuring in its 89-year history.

Workers hold 10 seats in the decision-making supervisory Board of the company and shareholders, including the State of Lower Saxony, another 10. The job cuts were announced after a tense meeting of the Board.

“Volkswagen is simply not a corporation that operates solely according to capitalist rules. Because of its history, Volkswagen also belongs to us, the employees,” Daniela Cavallo, top union representative, said, as quoted by

the *Wall Street Journal*.

Much of the money spent on building a plant at its Wolfsburg headquarters in the 1930s came from the earnings of the company’s workers seized during Adolf Hitler’s reign, and that gives a sense of ownership even to the present-day workforce.

The agreement stopped short of an announcement on closing down four factories at Emden, Hanover, Zwickau and Neckarsulm in Germany, deemed to have no future after 2030, when electrification is expected to stub out production of cars powered by internal combustion engines in Europe. The company has reset its targeted production to nine million vehicles a year, from 12 million before the COVID-19 pandemic and 10 million recently.

On the other hand, JLR, the cash cow of Tata Motors, is targeting £1.7 billion (around ₹28,000 crore) in savings through the job cuts, reports said. The cuts will largely target the white-collar

workforce, while direct manufacturing jobs will be protected.

The company will scale down its breakeven point to 3 lakh vehicles from 3.5 lakh, reducing annual sales by 14% to cover its cost base. This will make it fitter in a rapidly evolving global market due to rapid technological change, intense competition, and geopolitical uncertainty, JLR chief executive P.B. Balaji said.

Why are the two carmakers on the skids?

Volkswagen ruled Chinese roads for four decades till its growth engines started sputtering. The world’s largest carmaker after Toyota was late to the EV race with fleet-footed Chinese carmakers, after dominating the market through a string of joint ventures. Even in Latin America and Africa, dominant markets of the German giant, Chinese carmakers are giving Volkswagen nightmares. In China, its sales skid by one-third of the 2019 figures, reports said.

There is no model blitz in taking on Chinese rivals pumped up by cheaper state-backed loans. The company lost out to manufacturers such as BYD and Geely owing to a perceived reluctance to take the wheel in the EV race.

For JLR, with the U.S. as its largest market but with no American production base, Donald Trump’s tariffs have created potholes on the road to profits. The tariffs on exports to the U.S. from the U.K. range

from 10% to 15% for its models. It was China where its sales plummeted the most despite its electric-only reinvention.

How are the companies changing gears in India?

Volkswagen, which underwent a renaissance in India in recent years as Skoda Auto Volkswagen India Private Ltd., with models made for India, is looking for an active partner for its business. Volkswagen expects to sign a deal with a local partner in India this year, the chief executive officer of its Skoda brand, Klaus Zellmer, said in India, as the German group struggles to build scale in the world’s third-largest car market, *Reuters* reported in August.

Skoda is in charge of the group’s strategy in India, where Volkswagen is in talks on a joint venture with the JSW group, which has indicated it wants a majority stake. Mr. Zellmer said VW was in discussions with an unnamed partner and was confident of completing a deal this year.

JLR is a wholly owned subsidiary of Tata Motors, which acquired the iconic British luxury automaker in 2008. It clocked its best first-quarter retail sales for 2026-27 at 1,665 vehicles, an 11% year-on-year increase, in India. The India-U.K. free trade agreement is benefiting the company. JLR and Tata Motors opened a plant in Ranipet in Tamil Nadu in February 2026.

ECONOMIC NOTES

Why India must rethink the way it values skills, jobs and productive work

India risks a middle-income, low-productivity trap as weak job creation, stagnant wages and sluggish investment reinforce one another; escaping it requires better vocational education, wider diffusion of technology and useful knowledge, and greater social value for skilled work

Kalaiyarasan A.

India, celebrated as the world’s fastest-growing economy, has become the world’s fourth-largest economy, and is expected to be the next engine of global growth. Yet beneath these numbers lies a grim reality: India is drifting toward the middle-income trap, in which countries exhaust their gains from cheap labour and rapid catch-up and fail to transition to an innovation-driven, productivity-based economy. Weak job creation, stagnant wages, sluggish private investment, and low productivity are reinforcing one another, threatening to stall the country’s rise before it reaches high-income status. Many countries in the Global South are caught in this trap. India’s structural crisis is unique and more serious than not just a consequence of wars in West Asia disturbing its supply chain or premature automation from AI.

The signs of distress are visible in the youth protests across the country. Private investment remains sluggish, wage growth is stagnant, and household consumption is weak. Manufacturing has failed to generate enough jobs, while post-pandemic recovery has favoured large corporations and the digital economy, leaving the informal sector barely touched. Jobless growth emerges because productivity gains stay concentrated in narrow, capital- and skill-intensive enclaves that create little employment. This simultaneous rise of rising inequality and low productivity is a dangerous trap.

Two failing engines

Economists are typically divided in explaining this trap. Those trained in pro-market orthodoxy argue India needs another set of market reforms – no less than what occurred during the 1991 moment – more labour flexibility, agricultural reform, deregulation, and infrastructure investment. Those on the left and typically in the Keynesian mould argue that the economy suffers from weak aggregate demand and needs more public spending, redistribution and social protection. Both arguments hold a kernel of truth, but miss the larger point: India’s current situation stems not only from supply and demand constraints but from institutions shaped by social norms, which decide both how markets set incentives and prices, and how the State allocates resources and provides public goods.

It is no surprise, then, that both the State and the market operate suboptimally. Private capital, more freer from regulation than ever, does not do well on productivity and innovation. Its competitiveness comes from cutting costs rather than innovating. It couldn’t even absorb knowledge that comes with FDI. It couldn’t increase productivity that results from both inter-sectoral movements and innovation within sectors either. On the other hand, capital is heavily subsidised, lowering its relative price vis-à-vis labour in a labour-surplus economy. India’s innovation is skewed, with R&D spending at a paltry 0.65% of GDP, while technology adoption remains weak and far from spontaneous. Despite the government’s growing size, India’s capacity to intervene – even to provide basic services like health centres or schooling – remains among the lowest



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anywhere.

The Left-Right debate focuses on the size and quality of government expenditure, but the problem lies elsewhere. The same social norms that shape resource allocation also drive its inefficient use. For instance, India has historically underfunded mass education while subsidising higher education for elites, tilting spending toward the privileged. That same elite bias later drove the service-sector-heavy growth of post-reform India, letting upper castes monopolise better occupations while relegating low-productivity work to others.

Undervaluing useful skills

India’s social norms are distinctive: they decide how State and market function while producing durable inequality and legitimising it. Having long undermined mass education, India’s vocational training system remains poorly managed and chronically underfunded. Fewer than 3% of the workforce has any formal vocational education. Of roughly 14,000 ITIs offering about 25 lakh seats, actual intake is only about 48%, and even among graduates, the employment rate is just 63% – far below the 90%-plus seen in many other countries.

Societies set up institutions based on their interests and norms. Economists often take self-interest as central to economic motives. Yet social norms determine the kind of institutions that take shape, which in turn decide how individual efforts are channelised into productive activities. These institutions work as the taproot of entrepreneurial success. As this year’s Nobel Prize winner Joel Mokyr has argued, modern growth depends on the accumulation and diffusion of “useful knowledge,” the practical skills that enable societies to innovate, adapt and raise productivity.

For Mokyr, sustained growth rests on the coevolution of science, technology and the spread of useful knowledge,

something that failed to take strong root in India. India has historically privileged abstract education over vocational and technical knowledge. University degrees command prestige while technical courses training electricians, welders, machinists and carpenters do not. This hierarchy is not accidental. It reflects centuries of caste-based occupational stratification, where manual and artisanal work has been systematically undervalued despite its indispensable role in industrial development.

The result is a chronic shortage of skilled manufacturing workers even as millions of educated young Indians struggle to find decent jobs. Ironically, India’s Chief Economic Adviser, V Anantha Nageswaran, recently urged the youth to pursue trades such as welding and plumbing instead of chasing software jobs or MBAs.

But it won’t happen unless India changes its social valuation of skills. Take the marriage market: some skills and occupations carry a premium over others. These social valuations shape educational choices, occupational aspirations and ultimately the allocation of labour.

Data show a persistent and steady decline in the labour intensity of production technology across sectors. Even in traditionally labour-intensive sectors, the trend is likely to accelerate with the advent of AI. India therefore needs to recalibrate not just production and distribution, but also their valuation. Without changing the cultural valuation of skills and the way production itself is organised, India may fall into a low-income, low-productivity trap.

Diffusion of useful knowledge

Countries that escaped the middle-income trap – from South Korea to China – did not simply build factories but built institutions capable of creating and diffusing useful knowledge across domains. China’s interventions in education and health laid the foundation

for its later productive capacity. Its early state-led industrialisation was accompanied by massive investments in technical education, local manufacturing capability and technological learning. By contrast, countries such as Brazil, Argentina, Thailand and the Philippines, which failed to build or sustain such institutions, became stuck in the middle-income trap. Like India, large sections of their populations remain dependent on public transfers and handouts to secure the basic requirements of a prosperous existence.

As an alternative to this trap, Harvard Economist Dani Rodrik has recently proposed what he calls productivism – an approach that shifts attention from ex-post redistribution to creating productive employment. It calls for the dissemination of economic opportunity and differs from free market orthodoxy in giving the government an important role over the markets in shaping economic opportunities. It emphasises the real economy over finance, jobs over redistribution and production over consumption. A truly inclusive economy, according to him, gives people dignity and social recognition as productive members of society. It can happen not just by recalibrating the policy framework but by overhauling the institutional framework and changing the norms that underpin those institutions by moving beyond the matrix of state-market binaries.

For India, this means combining industrial policy with investments in vocational education. It also means restoring dignity to skilled manual work and creating institutions that spread technology beyond a handful of elite enclaves. Without transforming how the country values skills, builds productive capabilities, and expands access to good jobs, India risks being locked into a low-productivity economy.

(Kalaiyarasan A. is Associate Professor, Madras Institute of Development Studies)

THE DAILY QUIZ

Test your knowledge of the battle in which William Wallace, Andrew de Moray turned a narrow crossing on the River Forth into one of Scotland’s most consequential victories

Prathmesh Kher

QUESTION 1

Which two Scottish commanders jointly led the forces at Stirling Bridge?

QUESTION 2

How many horsemen could reportedly cross the bridge abreast?

QUESTION 3

What type of Scottish formation played a crucial role in repelling the English cavalry?

QUESTION 4

Which English knight famously managed to fight his way back across the bridge after the Scottish attack?

QUESTION 5

According to the contemporary English chronicler Walter of Guisborough, approximately how many English infantry and cavalry were killed?



Visual Question:

Identify the actor in this scene from the famous 1995 film *Braveheart*, which depicts the life of William Wallace and the Battle of Stirling Bridge. 20TH CENTURY FOX FILM CORP

Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1.

Vilkanundu Swapnangal was Mammootty’s first credited role, where he played the antagonist. However, his first appearance on screen was in a movie released almost 10 years before. **Ans: Anubhavangal Palichakal**
2. In 2010, the prolific actor released a memoir about his early life. **Ans: Chamayangal**
3. Mammootty and Mohanlal have acted side-by-side in a lot of films. One of the most popular films was *Harikrishnans*, released in 1998. A popular Bollywood actor was the female lead in the film. Name the actor. **Ans: Juhi Chawla**
4. In 2017, this film of Mammootty wherein he played a police officer was criticised by actor Parvathy for

glorifying misogyny. **Ans: Kasaba**

5. This film by Jabbar Patel won Mammootty national fame for playing this iconic economist, social reformer and politician. **Ans: Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar**
6. The Jabbar Patel film is not the only movie in which Mammootty played a political icon. This 2019 film saw him bringing to life this leader who was the Chief Minister of a southern State. Name the film and the leader. **Ans: Yatra; Y. S. Rajasekhara Reddy**
Visual: This still of Mammootty and Bollywood actor Aishwarya Rai is from a Tamil movie, which was an adaption of a Jane Austen novel. **Ans: Kandukondain Kandukondain; Sense and Sensibility**
Early Birds: K.N. Viswanathan | Abhay Krishan | Varghese Joseph | Shanavas Aboobaker | Prem Nath Tiwari



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

“What are you reading?”
“An article on global warming. It says here that the weather in our country...”
“.... I’m not interested. Right now I am only interested in finishing”
“... how do you pronounce e..q..u..a..b..l..e?”
“What?”
“E..q..u..a..b..l..e.”
“Well, the first ‘e’ is like the ‘e’ in ‘set’, ‘bet’, and ‘met’. The ‘qu’ sounds like the ‘qu’ in ‘quality’, ‘quit’, and ‘quick’. The ‘a’ is like the....”
“It’s like the ‘a’ in ‘China’, while the final ‘ble’ is probably like the ‘ble’ in ‘bubble’, ‘trouble’, and ‘double’.”
“Exactly! The main stress is on the first syllable. Any idea what the word means?”
“Sure I do. People usually talk about an ‘equable settlement’. That....”
“....sorry! The word you are thinking of is ‘equitable’, not ‘equable’.”
“What’s the difference?”
“When you say that something is ‘equable’, it means it is regular, moderate, free from extremes. The word is often used to refer to the climate. For example, the climate in Rajasthan is anything but equable.”

“Many people say that Hyderabad has an equable climate.”
“You must be joking. Hyderabad gets really hot during the summer. I have heard quite a few people say that Bangalore is equable. But let’s not get into an argument over the weather. Can ‘equable’ be used with people as well?”
“Yes, it can. When you say that someone is ‘equable’ what you are implying is that the person is even tempered.”

“In other words, the individual has no mood swings. Like the climate, the person has no extremes.”
“I guess you could say that. No matter what the situation is, the individual is calm and cheerful. Like me!”
“Like you? You must be joking! How about this example? It’s a pleasure working with Gitanjali because she is so equable.”

“That’s a good example. His equable temperament made Bala quite a popular teacher.”
“Everyone had told Venkat that his new boss was equable and that he would enjoy working with him. So he was quite surprised when the man snapped at him for coming late to office.”
“Bosses are so unpredictable. Tell me, what does ‘eQUITable’ mean?”
“The stress is on the first syllable. It’s pronounced Equitable.”
“I see. What does Equitable mean?”
“It means just or impartial.”
“I see. The Minister has asked the management and the union to come up with an equitable compromise. How does that sound?”

“Good. The lawyer ensured that there was an equitable division of property among the three brothers.”
“The two parties were interested in arriving at an equitable settlement.”
“It’s very difficult to arrive at an equitable compromise.”
“I know. By the way, how is your friend Dilip doing? Has he found a job?”
“No, he hasn’t. He keeps ringing me up every day and talks to me for hours. I feel sorry for him. But there are times when he drives me up the wall.”
“Drives you up the wall?”
“When you say that someone is driving you up the wall, it means that the individual is driving you crazy.”
“So it’s the same thing as ‘driving someone nuts’.”
“That’s right.”

Published in *The Hindu* on December 11, 2001

Word of the day

Punctilious:

marked by precise accordance with details

Synonyms: careful, meticulous, scrupulous

Usage: *She is punctilious about following the rules.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/punctilious

International Phonetic Alphabet: /pʌŋkʃltiʃəs/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

From Page One

SC asks Centre to review NEET-SS cut-off decision

Justice Narasimha advised the Additional Solicitor-General to “reflect a little more” about bringing down the percentile, and even consult with other members of the Bar on the issue.

Ms. Bhati urged the court then to “add a line” in its order “directing us to reconsider this... to consider reduction to the extent possible”.

The law officer revealed that even some of the experts had “varying views” on the question of lowering the qualifying percentile.

“Some amount of reduction can be made. For last years, we had even reduced it [qualifying percentile] to 0%,” Ms. Bhati submitted.

The court scheduled the case for further hearing and directions on September 17.

Take action against threats to minor: SC

The student’s counsel submitted that a “vigilante” had “bragged” on social media about the hurt caused to her and her family. “She is a *bona fide* victim. She is also a vulnerable victim. No irreversible harm should befall the child or her family,” the lawyer said.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the Bench with Justice V. Mohana, said the Uttar Pradesh Police should take responsibility for the safety of the student and her family. “The FIR in the Parliament Street police station relates to allegations of miscreants threatening, harassing, intimidating and having indulged in acts of violence against her. If they are true, we would like you to take immediate action on the FIR, and file a report here. Police protection must be given to the victim and family by the police in Uttar Pradesh where she is presently claiming to reside,” Justice Bagchi addressed the top law officer.

Recently, the Delhi Police had arrested influencer Swatantra Bhardwaj in connection with the alleged assault on the father of a student during the NEET protests.

The counsel for the student argued that vulnerable victims like her client should be able to safeguard their privacy by directly approaching the top court or accessing the Supreme Court-appointed High-Powered Enquiry Committee.

‘India-Canada trade deal by end of the year’

“Our hope is that we get there by the time of a Modi visit to Canada, which would mean achieving this in about nine months [since March],” the Canadian High Commissioner said. “That’s like a child – we hope this is a really nice baby.”

Mr. Cooter acknowledged that while trade between India and Canada is currently small (about \$8 billion), the investment relationship is a strong one. “So, you actually provide good employment for 1,00,000 Canadians in Canada through Indian investment in Canada,” Mr. Cooter said.

“The other part of the story is that, while trade itself is rather small, the pension funds and other big institutional investors have about \$100-110 billion Canadian dollars or \$80 billion U.S. dollars in investment in India.” This, he said, placed Canada among the largest investors in India, along with Singapore and the UAE. “But the difference with Canadian investment is that our investment through these institutional investors is also direct investment,” Mr. Cooter explained.

“We estimate that no less than 75% of all our investment through those funds is in physical assets. And no other country has that,” he added.

Seven years on, China President to visit India

The talks between the two Ministers will give both sides the opportunity to take stock of a growing but challenging trade relationship and air their respective concerns, with India seeking an easing of export controls and China wanting further relaxation of investment restrictions.

Mr. Xi’s visit in itself holds enormous significance for the relationship in the view of India and Chinese officials, and for the continued normalisation process. Especially on the Chinese side, a visit by Mr. Xi to India, after a seven-year gap, is seen as important signalling to the Chinese system on where relations are headed after a difficult period.

Border tensions starting in April 2020, culminating in a clash at Galwan Valley in June, brought a four-year freeze in relations. Following a meeting between Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi in October 2024 on the sidelines of the BRICS summit in Kazan, both sides have begun a gradual and steady normalisation in relations.

Mr. Modi and Mr. Xi last met at the SCO Summit in Tianjin, China, in August last year, when they both “welcomed the positive momentum and steady progress in bilateral relations” and “reaffirmed that the two countries were development partners and not rivals, and that their differences should not turn into disputes.”

“I would describe it as strategic risk management rather than strategic realignment,” Hu Shisheng, Director of the South Asia Institute at the China Institutes of Contemporary International Relations in Beijing told *The Hindu* in a recent interview.

Wars, global crises may top agenda of BRICS summit

Vladimir Putin, Xi Jinping, UN Secretary-General Guterres are among top leaders set to attend the summit scheduled for this weekend; Putin is likely to hold bilateral meeting with Modi today

Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI

Russian President Vladimir Putin is expected to arrive here on Friday morning to attend the 18th BRICS summit that will be held here this weekend, Russian sources said.

Mr. Putin is likely to hold a bilateral meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi hours after his arrival, where the two sides are expected to discuss defence and other related matters. Mr. Putin is among the top leaders of BRICS members and partner countries who are scheduled to arrive for the September 12-13 summit.

Several heads of multilateral organisations, including United Nations Secretary-General Antonio Guterres, are also scheduled to attend the BRICS summit.

The External Affairs Ministry has confirmed that, apart from Mr. Putin, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Egyptian President Abdel Fattah El-Sisi, Ethiopia’s Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali, and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto are among the top leaders who are expected to reach Delhi for the summit that is being held against the backdrop



Centre of attention: Flags of various countries on display as preparations for the 18th BRICS summit are under way at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on Thursday. PTI

of a global crisis in the supply chains of energy and agriculture because of wars in West Asia and Ukraine.

The conflict in West Asia that started in February, when Israel and the U.S. launched a joint attack on Iran, is likely to be among the top topics of the summit, especially as Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian is scheduled to be here. This will be the first visit to India by Mr. Pezeshkian since he took charge after the death of President

Ebrahim Raisi in 2024.

Mr. Pezeshkian met Mr. Modi on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyz Republic, on August 31. That was the first meeting between the two leaders since the war began.

The differences between Iran and the United Arab Emirates (UAE) will be keenly watched as the two sides have been exchanging tough messages because of the ongoing hostilities in the region.

The UAE will be represented by Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi Sheikh Khaled bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, the Ministry informed. The Gulf Cooperation Council, which is also in focus because of the hostilities in the Persian Gulf region, will be represented by Abdullatif bin Rashid Al Zayani, Foreign Minister of Bahrain. Among the founding members of BRICS, South Africa will be represented by Cyril Ramaphosa and Brazil will be represented by Mauro Vieira.

SC seeks clarity on FSSAI’s warning label norms

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday questioned the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) on how it proposed to determine whether packaged foods were “high” in sugar, salt or fat as part of its proposed front-of-pack warning labels, as it underlined that food safety was a cause of “national interest”.

The FSSAI had last month proposed prominent red warning labels on packaged foods high in added fat, added sugar or salt, marking a regulatory pivot after the top court questioned its reluctance

to introduce such warnings.

In an affidavit filed before the court, the food regulator said the labels would take the form of a red hexagonal warning on the front of packages where a product was found to be high in two or more specified nutrients of concern – fat, sugar or salt. The thresholds would be based on those prescribed under the Dietary Guidelines for Indians, 2024, issued by the ICMR-National Institute of Nutrition (NIN).

FSSAI’s affidavit

A Bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran, while examining the FSSAI’s affidavit, however,



questioned how the regulator would determine the threshold beyond which a packaged food would be classified as “high” in sugar, salt or fat. “If you ask them to put a label, say high in salt, high in sugar, high in sodium, high in potassium, how will you de-

termine it? Have you laid down any guidelines?” the Bench asked. Additional Solicitor-General Brijender Chahar, appearing for the Centre and the FSSAI, said the regulator was adhering to the guidelines issued by the ICMR-NIN.

The Bench was hearing a public interest litigation petition filed by non-profit organisations seeking warning labels on packaged foods to indicate high levels of salt, sugar and saturated fats. On Thursday, it indicated that it would soon pass a detailed order seeking further information from the stakeholders.

“We have done some homework and undertaken some study. We pro-

pose to pass an order calling for some further information from you. Study the order and come back with an appropriate further report,” Justice Pardiwala told Mr. Chahar.

‘Take orders seriously’

The top court also asked the regulator to take its directions “seriously”, stressing its concern over the impact of food safety standards on public health. “We are concerned with the health of people, more particularly growing children... We have taken it up very seriously... We expect one and all to extend cooperation in a cause which is in national interest,” Justice Pardiwala said.

Magistrate suspended over NEET protest notice

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta informed the Supreme Court on Thursday about the suspension of an Executive Magistrate of the Greater Noida Commissionerate who issued show-cause notice to a student in connection with the recent protests at Jantar Mantar. The Magistrate issued the notice despite a Supreme Court order prohibiting coercive measures against students part of the agitation.

Biotech Conclave to shed light on role of life sciences in shaping the future

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The VIT Chennai *The Hindu* Biotech Conclave 2026, to be held in Chennai today, will bring together leading experts, industry leaders and academicians for a dialogue on the growing role of biotechnology in shaping the future. Conceived as a student-centric platform, the conclave seeks to introduce higher secondary students, undergraduates, researchers and biotechnology aspirants to the opportunities, challenges and real-world impact of biotechnology.

The conclave will be inaugurated by Suchitra Ella, co-founder and managing director of Bharat Biotech, and CII-president designate. The programme will be presided over by G. Viswanathan, founder and chancellor of Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT). G.V. Selvam, vice-president, VIT, will deliver the special address.

Speaking about the con-



clave, Mr. Selvam said, “Through this conclave, VIT Chennai aims to encourage students to see biotechnology not only as a field of study, but as a pathway to innovation, enterprise and meaningful service to humanity.”

The opening session will feature a direct interaction between students and Ms. Ella, offering participants an opportunity to engage with one of India’s leading biotechnology entrepreneurs.

Also, Ganapathy, honorary distinguished professor, Indian Institute of Management-Jammu, distinguished professor, The Tamil Nadu Dr. M.G.R. Medical University and emeritus professor, Na-

tional Academy of Medical Sciences; Mayur Abhaya, managing director, LifeCell International; and Shridevi S, deputy director, Centre for NeuroInformatics, VIT Chennai, will discuss the convergence of technology and biotechnology in conversation with Zubeda Hamid, senior assistant editor, *The Hindu*.

Vinod Scaria, chief data officer, Karkinos Healthcare; Kalpana Gowrishankar, clinical geneticist and counsellor, Apollo Hospitals; and G. Jayaraman, dean, School of Bio Sciences and Technology, VIT Chennai, will discuss the movement of gene-based technologies from laboratories into clinical and public health contexts, in conversation with Geetha Srimathi. S, senior reporter, *The Hindu*.

Maneesh Paul, CEO, Microvioma, lead co-inventor and program director of the anti-infective Enmetazobactam, Orchid Pharma; Vasani Sambandamurthy, senior vice-president, Bug-

works Research India Pvt. Ltd.; and M.M. Balamurali, professor, Centre for Healthcare Advancement, Innovation and Research, VIT Chennai, will join Athira Elssa Johnson, senior reporter, *The Hindu*, in a discussion on India’s emergence as a global biopharma hub.

The funding landscape for biotech research in India will be explored by Ajay Mahipal, co-founder and general partner, HealthKois, in conversation with Serena Josephine M., special correspondent, *The Hindu*. The last session will feature K. VijayRaghavan of National Centre for Biological Sciences, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, in conversation with Jacob Koshy, Science Editor, *The Hindu*. It will explore India’s research and innovation ecosystem.

To watch the event live, scan the QR code or visit newsth.live/VITBTCLS

SC rejects 1993 blasts convict Abu Salem’s petition for release

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Thursday dismissed a plea by 1993 Mumbai serial blasts convict Abu Salem seeking release from prison on the ground that he had completed the required 25-year jail term.

Mr. Salem was extradited from Portugal to India in 2005 after a sovereign assurance that he would neither be sentenced to death nor imprisoned for

more than 25 years.

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta said it found “no infirmity” in the Bombay High Court’s April 15 ruling dismissing his petition for release, holding that the sovereign assurance could not be used to claim an “artificial or accelerated” computation of his period of incarceration. It said Salem’s claim for release could not be divorced from the “gravity” of crimes for which he was convicted.



APPEAL

Baby Milan Kumar Mondal, Manipal Hospitals No.H016847204, 1 year 11 months is Diagnosed to be suffering from Congenital Heart Disease, CIVD is a case of Tetralogy of Fallot, Confluent Branch PDA, LPA origin stenosis, small PDA L-R. VSD has outlet extension. He requires to undergo Dacron patch closure of VSD. The estimated cost of the surgery is Rs.6,00,000/-.

Please send donation however small by Cheque/D.D/M.O Fav. **Save Poor Lives A/c Milan Kumar Mondal, Our A/c Details:** S/B A/c No. 20000913487. S.B.I. R.A.Puram, IFSC CODE:SBIN0001855. Please Donate by G-pay No.9884607377, UPI Id: savepoorlives@oksb. Donations are exempted under 80G of I.T.ACT.

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FAITH

Four paths to reach God

The two important paths of devotion are *Thothiram* and *Sasthiram*. *Thothiram* represents emotional and heartfelt devotion, while *Sasthiram* represents philosophical and intellectual understanding. Though their approaches differ, both lead the soul towards the same divine truth, said Lanka Sri Jeyaraj in a discourse.

Saiva Siddhanta explains four paths to reach God: *Chariya*, *Sriya*, *Yoga*, and *Jnana*. *Chariya* is external service and worship; *Kriya* connects external worship with inner devotion; *Yoga* is inward worship; and *Jnana* is the highest state of spiritual realisation. Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar and Manikkavasakar are traditionally associated with these four paths respectively.

Manikkavasakar represents the path of *Jnana*. In *Thiruvagasam*, he expresses his struggle between worldly attachments and his longing for Shiva. Though God comes to him with compassion and calls him, he feels unable to leave worldly life completely. Later, realising the greatness of the divine opportunity he had failed to embrace, he cries out in longing, regret and surrender.

That cry of the soul is *Thiruvagasam* – the longing to leave worldly bondage and become completely one with God. Manikkavasakar repeatedly expresses that human beings are trapped by ego, desire, attachment, karma and ignorance, and that they cannot free themselves by intellect alone. Liberation comes when Shiva's grace awakens the heart.

Manikkavasakar often speaks like a helpless child calling to a compassionate parent: "I have many faults, yet do

INBRIEF



Rupee slumps 44 paise to close at 95.52 against dollar

The rupee depreciated 44 paise to close at 95.52 against the U.S. dollar on Thursday, as Brent crude breached the USD 102 threshold, mounting concerns over the country's import cost trajectory. Forex traders said the currency is currently facing opposing forces, with downside pressure driven by a resumption of foreign portfolio outflows, following positive flows in July and August and crude oil trading above \$102 per barrel. PTI

Ultraviolette to establish 'BIGGA' factory in Hosur

Electric two-wheeler maker Ultraviolette said it would be setting up a Big Global Ambition (BIGGA) factory in Hosur, Tamil Nadu. The facility will provide capacity and infrastructure required to support the company's next phase of growth in India and international markets. The facility will manufacture Tesseract e-scooters, and provide the capacity and scale to support the company's future product portfolio across multiple segments including Sports, Crossover, Cruiser, Street and Scooters, the company said.

OALP deepwater bidding deadline extended till Nov. 15

The Directorate General of Hydrocarbons (DGH) has extended the deadline for submitting bids for deepwater and ultra-deepwater blocks under the 10th and 11th rounds of the Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP) by nearly two months until November 15. The revised deadline replaces the earlier September 17 cut-off. Bidding for onland and shallow-water blocks under the two rounds has already closed. The 10th OALP round was opened in April last year, while the 11th round was opened in March this year.

Canara Bank to raise up to ₹4,500 cr. through AT-I bonds

Canara Bank on Thursday said it would raise up to ₹4,500 crore through Basel III-compliant Additional Tier 1 (AT-I) bonds. This offer of issuance is part of a capital-raising proposal where the bank had been authorised by its Board of Directors to raise an amount up to ₹4,500 crore through AT-I bonds and ₹4,000 crore through Tier 2 bonds, the lender said in a statement. The proposed AT-I bonds would be perpetual debt instruments with a call option of five years, subject to regulatory clearance.

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF ANDHRA PRADESH LIMITED
(A Government of Andhra Pradesh Undertaking & an ISO 27001-2022 Certified Company)
VIDYUTH SOUDHA, VIJAYAWADA-520004.

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE

The APTRANSCO invites bids online for **Spec No. PMMTC2-e-43/2026, Work:** "Supply and laying of 48F OPGW at certain LLD locations, earth wire replacement and bottom cross arm works under RMI 2024-25, RMI 2025-26 & RMI 2026-27 schemes". **Date & Time of availability of Tender: 11.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs.** Web: <http://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in> Contact No.8332949383.

R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/131/26-27 **Sd/- Chief Engineer/Telecom & IT**

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E-mail:- sephed123@yahoo.com, Ph. No. 02932-222678
क्रमांक:-अअ/वृत्त पाली/त.स./2026-27/2336-2357 दिनांक:- 02/09/2026

अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना संख्या 05/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल की ओर से निम्नलिखित कार्यों हेतु जन स्वा. अभि. विभाग में उपयुक्त श्रेणी में पंजीकृत अनुबन्धकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ईओ प्रोक्यूरमेंट प्रक्रिया द्वारा ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

निविदा का कार्य	Annual Rate Contract for Construction & Commissioning of 200 mm Dia. Tube Wells with 5 Year O&M including 2 Years Defect Liability Period Under Division Pali, Sojat and Falna and Annual Rate Contract for Construction & Commissioning of 125 mm Dia. Hand pump /Single phase power pump bore well with 2 Years Defect Liability Period Under Division Pali, Sojat and Falna
निविदा की कुल लागत (लाख रुपये में)	1 निविदा निविदा संख्या 05 (आईएम स 1 से 6) की कुल राशि 1500.00 लाख रुपये
कुल धरोहर राशि	निविदा की अनुमानित लागत का 2 प्रतिशत या नियमानुसार
फार्म मिलने की तारीख	04.09.2026 से 17.09.2026 सांय 6.00 बजे तक
फार्म जमा कराने की तारीख	17.09.2026 सांय 6.00 बजे तक
निविदा खोलने की तारीख	18.09.2026 दोपहर 3.00 पीएम

निविदा से संबंधित समस्त विवरण वेबसाईट <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/>, <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> में देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in/> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।

1. PHE2627WSOB4967, 2. PHE2627WSOB4968, 3. PHE2627WSOB4969
4. PHE2627WSOB4970, 5. PHE2627WSOB4971, 6. PHE2627WSOB4972

DIPRC/15671/2026 (मनीष माधुर) अधीक्षण अभियन्ता जन स्वा अभि विभाग, वृत्त पाली

Equity MF inflows up 18%, SIP growth flat for third month

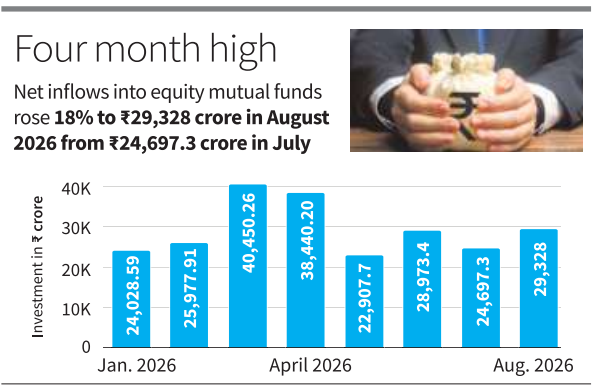
Beneath the headline flows, there appears to be a meaningful rotation of investor capital away from large-cap and some diversified strategies towards mid-cap, small-cap and select hybrids

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Net inflows into equity mutual funds rose 18% to a four-month high of ₹29,328 crore in August 2026, even as investor contributions through systematic investment plans (SIPs) plateaued for the third consecutive month, according to data from the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE).

Mutual fund investors poured ₹24,697.3 crore into the market in July 2026, which was 15% lower than the June inflows of ₹28,973 crore. As a result, the August figures appear higher largely because they are being compared with the relatively low base recorded in July 2026.

SIP contributions stood at ₹32,297 crore during the



reporting month, up just 1.5% over July 2026 level. The modest increase marks the third consecutive month in which the pace of SIP growth has plateaued, indicating a slow-down in incremental investor contributions through the route.

“Overall, the aggregate collection number does not tell the complete story. Beneath the headline

flows, there appears to be a meaningful rotation of investor capital away from large-cap and some diversified strategies towards mid-cap, small-cap and select hybrid categories. The key question going forward is whether this represents a sustained structural shift in asset allocation or simply a continuation of performance-led flows into segments that have

Bahrain court bins claims in HDFC Credit Suisse bond case

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

HDFC Bank said it secured favourable orders from High Civil Court, Bahrain, in two proceedings initiated by Credit Suisse Additional Tier 1 Bond (CS AT1), investors following judicial scrutiny of claims and evidentiary materials placed before the Bahrain Court.

Between July and August 2026, the Bahrain Court also rejected five other similar matters concerning investors of CS AT1, HDFC Bank said.

The seven investors alleged gross negligence, intentional misrepresentation, incorrect customer classification, non-disclosure of product features/ characteristics, misuse of financial leverage and violation of product suitability principles with respect to their investment in CS AT1 Bonds through the Bank. All the allegations were



The court also rejected five other similar matters.

rejected outright by the Court, HDFC Bank said. “The Bahrain Court rejected their claims outright after finding the investors failed to produce sufficient admissible evidence to prove/substantiate the allegations against the bank or that they suffered any loss owing to the bank,” it said. “In all the seven judgments by the Bahrain Court, the investors were ordered to bear the costs of the proceedings,” it added. The favourable out-

comes follow dismissal by the National Consumer Dispute Redressal Commission in India in March of complaints by the bond investors against the bank.

“In its order, NCDRC affirmed the bank was only a facilitator and the investors had full autonomy to make investments in CS AT1 Bonds as per choice and the investors voluntarily chose to make the investments and complained against the bank only after the investments failed to give expected returns and that the investors were well versed with the nuances at the time of investing,” HDFC Bank said.

“The bank is not in the business of underwriting investments made by customers out of own judgment and it will therefore defend itself rigorously against any unsubstantiated claims,” the private sector lender added.

‘Seeds Bill will not harm farmer rights’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Thursday said the proposed Seeds Bill would not be detrimental to the rights of farmers. Mr. Chouhan, who met about 20 farmers' organisations over the draft Seeds Bill and the Pesticides Management Bill, told their leaders that the Centre would finalise every policy on the basis of consensus after discussions with farmers.

Talking to reporters after the meeting Mr. Chouhan said the Seeds Bill passed in 1966 was no longer in tune with the contemporary farming practices.

He said 70% of seeds used by Indian farmers were outside the purview of the existing Act and it was necessary to crack down on “fake” seeds. He said the government was committed to protecting farmers' rights and that

traditional seeds would be conserved. “A traceability system will make it easier for farmers to identify the right seed,” he said.

Union Agriculture Secretary Atish Chandra and other senior officials also attended the meeting. Leaders of the Sangh Parivar's farmers outfit Bharatiya Kisan Sangh, various factions of Bharatiya Kisan Union, All India Kisan Coordination Committee (AIKCC), Kisan Mahapan-chayat and several other organisations presented their views on the Bills. Mr. Chouhan said there was a need for a new Pesticide Management Act to identify substandard pesticides.

PepsiCo eyes India as top 10 anchor market

Rahul Karmakar
NALBARI (ASSAM)

Food and beverage manufacturer PepsiCo opened its first foods factory in the Northeast, a geographically-challenged region not among India's preferred investment zones.

This is PepsiCo's fifth foods manufacturing plant in India. Jagrut Kotecha, CEO, PepsiCo India and South Asia, said the unit was part of the firm's investment commitment through 2030.

“This investment underscores the confidence that leading global companies have in Assam's business-friendly policies, infrastructure development and skilled workforce,” CM Himanta Biswa Sarma said.

He underscored the firm's commitment to ensure over 75% of its 700 direct staff are women.

“With our Assam, Madhya Pradesh and Tamil Na-



The plant is spread across 44.2 acre in Danguapara.

du operations , we hope to place India among our top 10 markets,” he added.

For agri-entrepreneurs PepsiCo plans to cover 80,000 smallholder farmers by nurturing 2,200 agri-entrepreneurs across Assam and West Bengal. The new unit will drive demand for more cold storage capacity, boosting Assam's agricultural infrastructure and potato value chain, he said.

India's 2026 oil demand to hasten by 0.06 mb/d

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

India's oil demand is likely to rise by about 0.06 million barrels per day (mb/d) in 2026 and accelerate further by 0.4 mb/d in 2027 on resilient economic growth and sustained demand for hydrocarbon fuels, the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) said in its latest monthly report.

OPEC expects India's oil use to average 5.7 mb/d in 2026, up from the previous year, with gasoline and diesel demand staying elevated on increased road mobility and higher vehicle sales. India's local growth momentum was resilient, supported by 'robust domestic demand and strong services,' despite global trade uncertainties and geopolitical headwinds, OPEC said.

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. वृत्त, जैसलमेर
क्रमांक:-अ.अ / जैसल / 2026-27 / 1250 दिनांक :-19.08.2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 02 / 2026-27
NIB No. PWD2627A2525

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से बजट घोषणा वर्ष 2026-27 के अन्तर्गत तहसील एवं सह उपतहसील कार्यालय का निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार / केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण / डाक एवम् दूर संचार विभाग / रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में कुल 02 कार्य जिनकी लागत राशि रु. 480.04 लाख है के लिए ईंटेन्डरिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है।

ऑनलाइन निविदा आवेदन डाउनलोड एवं अपलोड करने की तारीख	:	25 अगस्त 2026 प्रातः 9:30 बजे से 14 सितम्बर 2026, सांय 06:00 बजे तक
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निविदा से संबंधित विवरण वेब साईट <http://diipr.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन सम्पादित की जायेगी। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट पर <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।

1. PWD2627WSOB11328 2. PWD2627WSOB11329

(पी.एस. गहलोत)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. वृत्त जैसलमेर

DIPRC/15455/26

JAIPUR CITY TRANSPORT SERVICES LIMITED
No. - MD/JCTSL/2026-27/D - 1516 Date - 07/09/2026

Corrigendum - 01

This is with reference to JCTSL Bid No. 02/2026-27 published on <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> JCT2627SLOB00002 and <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> Tender ID 2026_JCTS_589839_1, some amendments are made. Detail of amendments can be seen and may be downloaded from above mentioned websites and JCTSL Website (<http://transport.rajasthan.gov.in/jctsl>).

Raj.Samwad/C/26/10559 **Chief Financial Officer**

GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
RFP Tender Notice No.30/2026-27/CE(GVMC)/SE(Mech)/EE(Mech)/DB/Dt:08-09-2026

01. No. of Works	: 1 (One) (RFP Tender)
02. Downloading Starting Date	: 08-09-2026 10.30 AM
03. Downloading End Date	: 25-09-2026 @ 5.00 PM
04. Last date for Submission of bid	: 25-09-2026 @ 5.01 PM

Further details at <http://www.eprocurement.gov.in>
O/o the Executive Engineer (Mech) Division **For Commissioner**

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600,),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/33/2026 **Date : 08.09.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited from manufacturers/direct importers / loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of Drugs for Multiple Sclerosis Under SID of KSSM for the year 2026 - 2027.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. Drugs
1.	KMSCL/ED/MULTI-SCLE/RC//2026/021 dtd. 08/09/2026	01

Last date and time of online uploading of tender - 22.09.2026, 5.00 pm.
Date and time of opening of Technical bid - 24.09.2026 11.00 am.

Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.
(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

MAHATRANSCO
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

SRM E-Tender Notice

Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Company Ltd, EHV PC O&M Zone Vashi invites bids through SRM e-Tender in two bid system (Techno-commercial Bid & Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for following works;

RFx No./ Tender No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost
7000041507	Augmentation substation by addition of 50MVA, 220/22kV PTR along with 1X 220kV GIS bay and 22kV GIS Consisting 6X 22kV feeder bay, 1X 22kV Incoming Bay, 1X 22kV PT bay, 1X 22kV Bus Coupler bay & interconnector bay along with allied Civil works at 220/22kV Kamba Substation under EHV (O&M) Division, Kalwa Vashi Zone (Transformer will be supplied by MSETCL).	Rs 1577.41 Lakhs excluding GST
T-12/ 2026-27		Rs 1861.35 Lakhs including GST

E.M.D. in Rs 15,77,415/-, Tender Fees: Rs 29,500/- including GST, **Sale period:** 10.09.2026 to 25.09.2026, **Last Date of Submission:** 25.09.2026 up to 12:00 Hrs, **Date of opening (Tech. bid):** 25.09.2026 at 12:30 Hrs(if possible). **Contact person:** Executive Engineer, EHV PC O&M Zone, Vashi. Phone No. (022) 27666010 (P) / 27665994. For further details please visit to <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>

Chief Engineer, EHV PC (O&M), Zone, MSETCL, Vashi

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600,),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/34/2026 **Date : 08.09.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited from manufacturers/direct importers / loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of Injections for Ankylosing Spondylitis Under SID of KSSM for the year 2026 - 2027.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. Drugs
1.	KMSCL/ED/ANKY-SPON/RC//2026/020 dtd. 08/09/2026	02

Last date and time of online uploading of tender - 22.09.2026, 5.00 pm.
Date and time of opening of Technical bid - 24.09.2026 11.30 am.

Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.
(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

JOB WELL DONE

‘Spinners had a good day, while it was difficult for the batters’



X@BCCIWOMEN

Happy with the way our batting and bowling are going, Spinners from both teams did well while the batters had it difficult. Small partnerships matter, especially on such a wicket. Deepti Sharma was excellent with the ball and got us a few breakthroughs — Captain Harmanpreet Kaur after India entered the Asia Cup final.

WONDERFUL FEELING

I am grateful to everyone who has supported me: Shami



R. RAGU

India pacer Mohammed Shami is thankful for his fans' support. "It feels wonderful to receive so much love and support, especially all the backing across social media. I am grateful from the bottom of my heart to everyone who has supported me along the way. My job is to put in the hard work, the rest is in the hands of the Almighty".

WAIT AND WATCH

October 2027 is still far away, we will see then: Rohit on World Cup



PTI

The ICC World Cup is still far away, said India opener Rohit Sharma on Thursday. The one-line response came on the sidelines of an event in Mumbai amid speculation about the former captain's future. "October 2027 is far away, we will see about it then," said Rohit who scored a hundred in India's final ODI against England.

HANGING IN

‘In other tournaments, I would have been out in the first round’



AP

In other tournaments, I would have been out in the first round but here I can fight back and play best-of-five, play four-and-a-half hours and somehow win the match and somehow get into the tournament... then I start playing better and definitely happy to be in the semifinals of the US Open — Alexander Zverev.

Shafali show as India marches into final

The opener makes the most of three dropped catches to lift the side to 149 for six before the spinners derail the Bangladesh chase

ASIA CUP
Press Trust of India
DUBAI

Shafali Verma lived a charmed life in her stroke-filled 64 (40b, 7x4, 3x6) as India entered the Asia Cup final with a comfortable 40-run win over Bangladesh here on Thursday.

On a slow surface where it was a struggle for majority of the batters, Shafali stood out to take India to 149 for six. The opener was dropped on six, 11 and 56 and she duly made Bangladesh pay for those mistakes.

While the other batters in the top four had a sub-100 strike rate, Shafali ended up with a stunning 160.

Considering the conditions and India's bowling resources, the seven-time champion was the favourite to defend the total and it did rather comfortably, limiting Bangladesh to 109 for seven.

Bangladesh never threatened in its reply. Dilara Akter (21 off 26) and her opening partner Juairiya Ferdous (14 off 18) fell while trying to force the pace.

Kranti Gaud's running catch to get rid of Dilara was a brilliant effort on an



Flexing her muscles: Shafali smashed 64 off 40 balls. X@BCCIWOMEN

otherwise ordinary day for the fielders.

Pratika Rawal put down a couple of catches.

The spin trio of Deepti Sharma (three for 26), Shree Charani (one for 14) and Prema Rawat (one for 21) delivered in favourable conditions.

Offie Shafali gave away only 25 runs from her quo-

ta of four overs.

The Women in Blue will play either Pakistan or Sri Lanka in Sunday's final.

The scores: India 149/6 in 20 overs (Shafali Verma 64, Sultana Khatun 2/30) bt Bangladesh 109/7 in 20 overs (Nandani Sharma 2/10, Deepti Sharma 3/26).

Toss: Bangladesh. PoM: Shafali.



Big prize: East Zone players and support staff rejoice after regaining the Duleep Trophy. R. RAGU

East Zone corners glory after a gap of 14 years

DULEEP TROPHY
S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

Kounain Quraishi's maiden First Class century (116 n.o., 190b, 13x4, 4x6) was the icing on the cake for East Zone as it clinched the Duleep Trophy after 14 years, beating South Zone by virtue of its first-innings lead on the final day of the summit clash at the MAC Stadium here.

Thursday's proceedings were largely academic once East had the lead in the bag on day four. Resuming at 212 for five, already ahead by 584 runs, Quraishi and Anukul Roy (64) piled on South's agony, adding 150 runs for the seventh wicket.

Against a tired South attack, Quraishi enjoyed himself in the middle on a

muggy day, feasting on some ordinary bowling.

Quraishi was given an array of treats: half-volleys down the leg-side, wide balls which he drove through the off-side and half-trackers from the spinners that were pulled away with the contempt they deserved.

Ishan Kishan eventually declared at 388 for seven just before tea to finish 760 runs ahead and bring the curtains down on the game.

Incidentally, East's last Duleep triumph also came at this venue in 2012 against Central Zone.

"Everyone came in with the same mindset. East Zone had assembled a very strong squad after many years, and we had to give our absolute best to make this opportunity count," said coach Ratan Kumar after his side's victory.

The scores: East Zone — 1st innings: 708 in 163 overs. South Zone — 1st innings: 336 in 107.3 overs. East Zone — 2nd innings: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi st. Jagadeesan b Vijay 8, Abhimanyu Easwaran c Padikkal b Siraj 3, Shikhar Mohan lbw b Rasheed 52, Ishan Kishan c Padikkal b Nidheesh 80, Kumar Kushagra c Jagadeesan b Milind 46, Sudip Kumar Gharami run out 2, Kounain Quraishi (not out) 116, Anukul Roy c Padikkal b Nidheesh 64, Mohammed Shami (not out) 0; Extras (b-7, nb-4, w-1, pen-5): 17; Total (for seven wkts. decl. in 99.2 overs): 388. Fall of wickets: 1-13, 2-13, 3-139, 4-154, 5-160, 6-238, 7-388. South Zone bowling: Siraj 16-2-47-1, Vijay 23-2-127-1, Shreyas 23-2-75-0, Nidheesh 9-2-28-2, Rasheed 16-1-57-1, Bhui 4-0-15-0, Milind 8.2-1-27-1. Match drawn. East won on first-innings lead. Player-of-the-Match: Ishan Kishan (East Zone). Player-of-the-Tournament: Tilak Varma (South Zone).

‘Self-motivation a must at this level’



Burning desire: Shami is still going strong. R. RAGU

S. Dipak Ragav
CHENNAI

Mohammed Shami had a dream 100th First Class game, ending up with a winner's medal around his neck, as East Zone clinched the Duleep Trophy here on Thursday.

The India pacer was operating close to his best (16-5-42-2) with both the new and old ball, keeping the South Zone batters on tenterhooks. "As far as satisfaction goes, achieving this in my 100th match — and winning the Duleep Trophy — is special. East Zone has won the trophy after a very long time. The last time we won back-to-back titles, I was part of one of those squads," said Shami.

Though he took only two wickets, Shami provided two breakthroughs at crucial junctures, removing key batters Shaik Rasheed and R. Smaran. He set them up nicely before delivering the final blow.

"Test (long-format) cricket is entirely a game of

setups. If the top-order batters are set, you cannot get them out without a plan. Wickets don't just happen out of nowhere, especially on tracks like this. The plan was to keep taking the ball away from him (Rasheed), build that expectation, and bring one back in sharply to trap him. That's precisely how it unfolded," Shami explained.

At 36, the Bengal fast bowler is probably in the final phase of his career, and he hasn't donned the National cap since March 2025 (ICC Champions Trophy). It is unclear if the selectors see a role for him looking at the future.

When asked what keeps him motivated to grind it out, he said, "There are plenty of reasons. You can draw positivity from this ground or any other ground you step on to. At this level, if you aren't self-motivated, your approach is wrong. No matter what stage you're playing at, your eyes must always be set on the next level."

Pipers in joint lead



Mixed luck: Humpy lost to Tsolakidou before beating Batsiashvili. SUDHAKARA JAIN

GLOBAL CHESS LEAGUE

P.K. Ajith Kumar
BENGALURU

Bibisara Assaubayeva had played seven games and won none. On the eve of her eighth game, her teammate Javokhir Sindarov joked she could take one of his Player-of-the-Match trophies from the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, as he had many.

Sindarov needn't be that generous, though Assaubayeva is his girlfriend. She won the award on her own, for her win against Polina Shuvalova, who hadn't lost a single game in the tournament. That win by Assaubayeva helped Fyers American Gambits beat Ganges Grandmasters 13-5 in the last match at the Lalit Ashok on Thursday and thus remain in the

joint lead with Alpine APL Pipers and Grandmasters as just two rounds remain in the round-robin phase.

The results: Alpine APL Pipers lost to Ganges Grandmasters 4-12 (Carlsen drew with Nepomniachtchi; Giri lost to Aronian; Vidit drew with Perez; Divya drew with Shuvalova; Humpy lost to Tsolakidou; Murzin drew with Mendonca). Triveni Continental Kings lost to Cheq Mumba Masters 5-14 (Firouzja lost to Vachier-Lagrave; Wei drew with Pranesh; Aravindh lost to Mamedyarov; Zhu drew with Harika; Kosteniuk bt Yip; Pranav lost to Daneshvar). Alpine Pipers bt PBG Alaskan Knights 11-6 (Carlsen bt Anand; Giri drew with Arjun; Vidit lost to Erdogmus; Divya drew with Lagno; Humpy bt Batsiashvili; Murzin bt Abhimanyu). Fyers American Gambits bt Ganges Grandmasters 13-5 (Sindarov bt Nepomniachtchi; Nihal lost to Aronian; Dubov bt Perez; Assaubayeva bt Shuvalova; Sarasadat drew with Tsolakidou; Maurizzi bt Mendonca).

Sindarov is the favourite but Gukesh has a chance: Carlsen

P.K. Ajith Kumar
BENGALURU

Magnus Carlsen is fond of R. Praggnanandhaa. Even after the Chennai Grandmaster beat him twice at the recent Norway Chess tournament in the World No.1's hometown, Oslo.

"I am a fan," Carlsen said. "I love watching him. He plays in a very aggressive way. It has been working out really well for him recently, and I don't think his approach has changed too much."

The five-time World champion, who is in the city for the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, likes the way Praggnanandhaa pushes his opponent hard. "He manages to put pressure on basically everybody, including myself," Carlsen said. "He is still not at a point where he can say that he has distanced himself from his peers. He is not quite consistent enough for that."

The world knows Carlsen isn't as much a fan of the other Chennai prodigy, though he is the reigning World champion. He doesn't feel it would be easy for D. Gukesh to defend his crown against Javokhir



Huge praise: Carlsen says he is a fan of Praggnanandhaa and loves his aggressive style. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Sindarov in their World title match.

"The way Gukesh has played for the last couple of years, he should not be in a position where he has to defend anything and should rather be in a position where he has everything to gain," Carlsen said.

High level

"Yes, he has shown previously in 2024 that he has, when things click, the potential to play at an extremely high level. I don't think a lot of people believe that he will do it now."

But he stressed that chess was a highly psychological game.

"So, it probably won't take a lot to potentially place some doubts in Sin-

darov's mind and some confidence in Gukesh's," he said. "As it stands, there is no question that Sindarov is the favourite."

Carlsen, however, feels that since chess is basically a drawish sport, and all one needed was a win or two in a World title match, Gukesh has chances.

"He has shown that his ceiling is on par with, or better than, Sindarov," he said.

"If Sindarov is ahead early on, it is bad news for Gukesh. If Gukesh is ahead early on, he automatically becomes a significant favourite."

Carlsen likes many things about the GCL. "The lack of increments is very good," he said.

Tiafoe-inspired Gauff makes a fightback of her own

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

Coco Gauff, drawing inspiration from Frances Tiafoe's epic comeback, saved two match points in her own fightback to reach the US Open women's semifinals on Wednesday.

The World No. 4 was on the brink of defeat in a second-set tie-breaker before ousting reigning French Open champion Mirra Andreeva 2-6, 7-6(7), 6-2. Gauff set up a clash with Elena Rybakina, who beat qualifier Zheng Qinwen 3-6, 6-1, 6-4 and will leap to World No. 1 next week.

Gauff's victory was much like compatriot Tiafoe's triumph over fellow American Alex Michelsen.

"Sometimes you just need a little bit of inspiration, and Frances was that [person] for me in that moment," the 22-year-old said.

"I was watching the end of that set and it looked like Frances was down and out. And sometimes you just need a chance, and I think I got my chances today."



Resolute: Gauff won despite being pushed to the limits. AP

THE RESULTS

Quarterfinals: Men: 1-Zverev (Ger) bt Van de Zandschulp (Ned) 6-2, 7-5, 6-1; Khachanov bt 28-Blockx (Bel) 6-2, 7-5, 3-2 (ret.) Women: 4-Gauff (USA) bt 5-Andreeva 2-6, 7-6(7), 6-2.

Gauff struggled in the first set and battled through four service breaks in a row in the second before a tie-break, where Andreeva had two match points but fired an errant forehand each time.

Two unforced errors on the final points gave the American her chance and she rolled through later. On the men's side, top-

seeded Alexander Zverev completed the semifinal line-up, cruising past Botić van de Zandschulp 6-2, 7-5, 6-1.

He will next face Karen Khachanov, who advanced when Alexander Blockx retired from their quarterfinal with the Russian leading 6-2, 7-5, 3-2.

Zverev won the last five games of the opening set to go one up after just 37 minutes. He saved a set point in the penultimate game of the second before breaking van de Zandschulp.

The German ran away with it in the third set to give himself another early night in the tournament.

Tilak ready for tryst with Tests?

How India are able to fit the batter into their red-ball scheme of things will be crucial in the months ahead; in the longer version, he has an impressive average in excess of 55 and a stellar conversion rate with eight centuries and seven fifties from 38 innings



R. RAGU

R. Kaushik

When he fell on Wednesday afternoon, caught and bowled by off-spinner Kounain Quraishi one agonising run short of his ninth First Class century, it was the first time in nearly two months and six competitive innings that Tilak Varma was dismissed.

Since making 53 in the final Twenty20 International against England in Southampton on July 11, the tall left-hander's scores, all unbeaten, read 6, 60 and 11 (in the T20Is in Harare), and match-winning efforts of 116 and 51 in the Duleep Trophy which helped South Zone make it to the final that they lost on the first innings lead to East Zone at Chepauk on Thursday.

Tilak's 99, controlled but not with the flair and panache that characterises his batting, was dictated by circumstances. Ishan Kishan, his opposite number, had sealed the destination of the title clash over the first two days. Making the most of his luck at the toss, the little left-hander smacked 270, his highest first-class score, to muscle his team to 708. All South could hope for was to muster some respectability in reply, because that humongous tally was always going to be well beyond them. Tilak therefore put the scoreboard out of his mind, took everything else out of the equation and concentrated on batting time.

Having spent most of the 163 overs - the length of the East first innings - on the field trying to devise ways and means of curbing Kishan and Kumar Kushagra, as well as the lower-order comprising Anukul Roy, Quraishi and Mohammed Shami, Tilak must have been fried mentally. But showing no signs of the fatigue that could have been his biggest stumbling block, the 23-year-old ground out an innings of great character, spanning more than five hours during which he negotiated 210 deliveries with care, assurance and defensive authority until he finally succumbed with a deserved three-figure milestone tantalisingly within grasp. Vocal and unabashed in his desire to play red-ball cricket for the country, this near-century was further proof that the Hyderabad wasn't merely paying lip service while professing his love for Test cricket. Indeed, immediately after the semifinal victory over North Zone in Bengaluru last week, Tilak went public by saying he wanted to play the final before travelling to Delhi for the T20I series against Afghanistan starting on Sunday. The end result wasn't what he had in mind, but by putting mind over matter and knuckling down to bed in despite the impossibility of the task ahead of him, Tilak once again showcased his immense maturity and added to the already firm reputation he has established as a man of his word.

Established T20I hand

By his own admission, the endearing young man thought he'd play red-ball cricket for India before being picked for

the white-ball outfits. But that's it they say about the best laid plans of men and mice? Tilak's maiden international outing came more than three years back, in a T20I against West Indies in Tarouba in August 2023; a month and a half later, he debuted in ODIs, against Bangladesh in the Asia Cup in Colombo. He has only played four further 50-over games, but is an established T20I hand with 59 appearances, averaging 44.45 at a strike-rate of 145.18. Just how highly he is rated by the powers that be is evidenced from the fact that when India chose to move on from the Suryakumar Yadav era despite the Mumbaikar leading the team to the World Cup crown in March, Tilak was named Shreyas Iyer's deputy.

At some stage in the near future, Tilak will don the captain's hat in potentially an interim capacity, before he ascends the hot-seat in his own right in due course. Tilak, the captain, is still a work in progress. That much was evident in the triangular 'A' series in Dambulla in June, where he led the 50-over side to the title. Tilak got into needless confrontations, which didn't make for great viewing, but clearly, he didn't transgress any forbidden lines. He will learn and grow and become more controlled with his aggression. He will become tactically smarter and more astute, he will become better with experience as anyone does in any field. It is clear that the selectors see in him a long-term leader, hence the vice-captaincy of the T20I team, the leadership role with the South Zone outfit and an investment that they hope will bear fruit going forward.

Tilak has done his chances of earning a Test call-up no harm at all. Despite sporadic appearances in domestic First Class cricket because of a packed calendar suffused with T20Is, meaningful and otherwise, the Duleep final is just his 25th appearance for state, zone and India-A since he first turned out for Hyderabad as a 16-year-old against Andhra in December 2018 - nearly eight years have gone by since. He has had his fair share of illnesses and injuries, as much a part and parcel of a professional sportsperson as their kitbag, but he has found a way to bounce back each time.

How committed he is to the longer version is apparent from an impressive average in excess of 55 and a stellar conversion rate - he boasts eight centuries and seven fifties from 38 innings. For someone who is a willing and able risk-taker in T20Is, whether it is at No. 3 where he has brought up both his hundreds or lower down the order, where he was shunted down midway through the World Cup, he is a picture of patience, concentration and correctness when he dons the white flannels and slips effortlessly into a diametrically opposite role.

How India are able to fit Tilak into their red-ball scheme of things will be crucial in the months ahead. In Kishan, he has a worthy rival in the quest for a spot in the Test squad. Sai Sudharsan and Washington Sundar, the former as a

top-order batter and the latter as an all-rounder with off-spin as an additional string to his bow, loom as further left-handed competitors in an already left-heavy line-up punctuated by Yashasvi Jaiswal, Devdutt Padikkal, Rishabh Pant and Ravindra Jadeja. There was a time when India struggled to find more than one settled left-hander to break up the tedium of right-handers and offer a different challenge to bowlers of all ilk. Now, there is a distinct slant in the other direction in one of those inexplicables because it isn't as if left-handers are suddenly being factory-manufactured.

But we digress. How do India's selectors, captain Shubman Gill and head coach Gautam Gambhir fit Tilak into this logjam? Equally importantly, do they want to do so immediately? For the last year and more, they have invested heavily in Sai Sudharsan, but the Tamil Nadu left-hander will be the first to acknowledge that he hasn't lived up to expectations. In his injury-enforced absence in Sri Lanka last month, Padikkal made a compelling case to continue at No. 3 with centuries in successive Tests on his comeback after 21 months on the sidelines. There is Dhruv Jurel who has done little wrong at No. 6. Where there is a will, there is a way, of course, but is the will there currently to find a place for Tilak?

India play two Tests in New Zealand, where of late their batting has come a cropper - of late being a bit of a stretch because India's last Tests in the land of the Kiwi were in early 2020, just before the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic. In modern-day cricket, no other country perhaps examines a batter's technique, character and strength of mind in the five-day game more than New Zealand, with its propensity for seaming tracks exploited admirably by a set of honest, hard-working but also highly skilled fast-bowling group. As if that challenge wasn't bad enough, India are desperately searching for the full complement of 24 points that will keep their World Test Championship qualification prospects alive. Given that India's last Test win in that country came in 2009 and they have gone winless in their last six matches, that is a tall order. But that's the nature of competitive sport, where nothing comes easy. Where several others might be secretly hoping to be overlooked for a challenge of this magnitude, Tilak will be desperate to get an opportunity to showcase his chops, because that's how he is wired. He has steadfastly refrained from taking the easy route in his short but already illustrious career, and he is not going to start doing so now.

It's easy to forget, given how permanent a fixture he is in the T20I setup with the vice-captaincy as an added bonus, that Tilak is still only 23, with an entire lifetime, so to say, ahead of him. The breezy advent of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi might make even 23 look ancient but let's face it, the 15-year-old is a freak and not the yardstick against which

others must be viewed and judged. Tilak's volume of work in just three years at the highest level is impressive even if almost all his success has come in the high-risk 20-over game. But there is minimal to zero evidence that he won't be at home in the longer formats, especially in Test cricket where, alongside Gill and Jaiswal, he will be one of the bulwarks of the Indian batting for a long time to come.

Grounded person

With someone else, it might feel prudent to point out the pitfalls of getting carried away and allowing success to go to one's head. But from whatever little one has seen of, and interacted with, him, Tilak comes across as a grounded, humble, earthy young man driven but not consumed by an inner fire that doesn't come to everyone. There is a short but dazzling line of fantastic batters to have come out of Hyderabad - the charismatic M.L. Jaisimha, the sinewy Mohammed Azharuddin and the exceptional V.V.S. Laxman, in some ways Azhar's successor and in many ways not. Tilak doesn't possess the same wristy elegance as his illustrious right-handed predecessors from the same city, but that doesn't make him any less of a batter. And just to set the record straight, one is not comparing him with the aforementioned trio of luminaries because, hey, how can you even, at this early stage? Or any stage? For Tilak, the future is pregnant with exciting possibilities. He needs opportunities, sure, but also quality of opportunity. How soon that comes his way remains to be seen.

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THE GIST

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K. MURALI KUMAR

